

Luo Min [China]

Anywhere the Sky Turns Blue

From the first ray of morning light leaping on the crest of the waves at the Cape of Good Hope, to the last star sinking into the abyss of the Pacific Ocean — among those lands with different names & similar outlines on the globe, there is a deep blue tremor which is silently being passed on. That is neither the guiding of a compass, nor the promise of the trade wind — it is poetry.

Time and again we raise the question: what, after all, is poetry? Is it a maze woven by words, or a reflection cast by the soul? This ancient question may never get an ultimate answer in this thin book. Poetry cannot be defined, just as wind cannot be put into a bottle. But when we open this collection of poetry containing pieces by authors from over ninety countries around the world, it is our firm belief that poetry is the unmarked paths on the map — from the sunset in Buenos Aires to a grain of sand in the heart of the Sahara, and from the crevices of volcanic rocks on the Icelandic tundra to the sides of ships in the Mekong Delta.

Over one hundred voices, from different continents, converge here. Their native languages and homeland may never have intersected, yet their poems share the same starry sky. Those sighs about love and loss, those yearnings for the homeland and imaginations of distant places, those humble yet great inquiries about existence written in the dead of night — in the long narrative of conflicts and reconciling among civilizations, on the century-old wounds scorched by war, migration and memory, the writers dig out their own gullies in their native language. And you, reading at this moment, fill them one by one with a different perspective, turning them into new rivers.

In the present era when vocabulary is increasingly scarce and meaning is on the thinning, in these poetic lines by poets from over ninety countries with different skin colors and beliefs, what, exactly, do we hear? We have heard the feathers of Sangore scattered across the Senegalese river valley, the lightning planted by Adonis between the Arabian wind and the crevices of wind, the pipe of the exiles, the songs hummed softly by the maidens in the trench, the ticking of melting glaciers, as well as the first chirping of cicadas in the forest after the machine has stopped running.

Literature has never promised happiness, yet it has promised truth. When the harmony formed by these sounds finally fulfills through your gaze, you come to understand: the human heart actually beats at the same frequency.

Now, what we hold in our hands is not merely a collection of poetry, but a container of memory, filled with the common imagination of beauty by different civilizations. We invite you, at dusk, to brew a pot of green tea — or to get a glass of whisky — and let these verses crossing seas & mountains to take you to the nearest street corner about you, or anywhere the sky turns blue.

The “world” in “World Poetry” is not merely a geographical concept, but also a dimension of the soul. These poems from over ninety countries are different phases of the same poem. It is through each other’s eyes that we learn to see, and to watch; it is through each other’s heartbeats that we hear in a real sense — the eternal poem has never ceased, and, under our shared vault of starry sky, there is soft singing and reciting.

The world is so vast, and there are some poetic lines which illumine — and grace — your night.

(Translated by Prof. Zhang Zhizhong)

TIAN XIA SHI GE

天下诗歌

Collection Editing (文集选编): MIN LUO

全球站

嘉陵江新诗研究会

Supervised by Nanchong Federation of Social Sciences

Organized by Nanchong City Jialing River New Poetry Society

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《天下诗歌》诗刊，将为全国 34 个行政区域每个行政区编辑一本诗歌专刊，展示全国各区域诗歌文化。现已出刊（四川、河南、陕西、香港、澳门、吉林、云南、广西、海南）9 个区域，已启动 28 个区域征稿，2026 年将全国各区域陆续出刊。国外臻选 60 个国家本土在世诗人作品，现征集稿件中。欢迎全国热爱新诗的朋友参与或共同完成！

本期为海外诗人作品，排名不分先后（以来稿先后排版），因版面有限，有诸多遗漏，敬请谅解。所有文责自负。

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ISBN-13: 979-8196109522

Publisher: Independently published

Text Compilation: Luo Min

Cover Design: Luo Min

Book Layout: Luo Min

Proofreading: Luo Min

Art Direction: Luo Min

Typography: Luo Min

Illustration: Luo Min

Production Supervision: Luo Min

First Edition: 2026

Published and distributed worldwide by Amazon KDP.

Printed in the United States

《天下诗歌》诗刊是嘉陵江新诗研究会会刊，已办刊 18 年。《天下诗歌》是川东北唯一的一份纯诗歌刊物，该刊物为免费赠阅形式。该刊坚持“博采众长，以质取胜”的选稿原则，推出了大批优秀诗作，深受广大诗友及读者喜爱，自创办以来，以开放、融合、学习的姿态，已刊发中国大陆、中国香港、中国台湾、中国澳门、法国、美国、加拿大、日本、德国、立陶宛、阿尔巴尼亚、塞尔维亚、西班牙、智利、葡萄牙、比利时、乌拉圭、巴基斯坦、黑山共和国、希腊、北巴其顿、哥伦比亚、印度、俄罗斯等全球一百多个国家七千多名作者诗歌数万首。出刊三万余册。



About the author

Agron Shele, a famous poet, born in Albania in 1972, is the author of the following literary works: Poetry books, Novels and Short Stories. He has published 19 books, 13 anthologies and a serial of magazines and newspapers in Albanian and many languages! He is President of the International Poetical Galaxy "Atunis" and coordinator of International Atunis Galaxy Anthology. He is winner of international literary prizes. He is published in many newspapers, national and international magazines. Currently resides in Belgium.

THE DAY OF MY BIRTHDAY

No more than a bitter descent
birds climbing the marsh paths,
their wings tracing departures
my eyes can't follow.

They vanish toward another dhera,
like those who chase a fate
that always slips their grasp.
Your sorrow lies above me,
mine runs through the bone
a peace that will not rest,
as your flight keeps losing horizons,
and freedom costs nothing.

Beyond autumn's reach, send me to my own shore,
to the high oak
where a whisper of breeze still sleeps.

I do not know
if it still breathes,
but my heart hangs there
suspended between leaving and return.

And to the bees, I said:
keep your final sting
for the life that comes after this one.

EVENING

Evening descends on the calm lake,
boats sleeping at the shore,
rocking the waves of the day
in the breeze,
where stars are reborn in the deep twilight
of the green park
and the cries of birds
melted one with the rustling of the waters
extending the thirst of the shore
until my pain
feeling the turmoil of the season
spreading the blood of the spirituality of a reborn
soul

A magic is hidden behind the sleep of the calm
waters
perhaps dreams
of the reflection of hair in emerald
hidden in the reeds,
where the bird of the wind raises its nest
and suddenly takes flight to the white cloud.

Evening
and vision reached so close,
reached from the most distant skies,
image revealed at the first touch
of the infinitely silent memory,

WHO ARE THE POETS?

They are words walking across time,
before time, with time
they are voices that silence cannot swallow.
They are the ones who see with the heart,
even when their eyes are closed.
They are the ones who feel the wound
before it opens on the skin.
Simply put: poets are a unique species
who resemble not even themselves.

WHERE DO POETS LIVE?

They have no home
except their own verses.
They have no city
except the dreams left in suspension.
They live between the footsteps of time,
where no one else has dared to walk.
Simply put: poets live somewhere between
dreams and the not-yet-arrived.



About the author

Jeton Kelmendi, a famous poet, playwright, translator, communication scholar, publicist, and university professor. He earned his doctoral degree in the field of media communication, and later obtained the academic title “Doctor of Science” with a dissertation on The Role of Media in EU Security Policies. He is the author of over 30 books of poetry, essays, drama, and academic studies. Jeton Kelmendi is a member of numerous international academies and literary institutions, including the European Academy of Sciences and Arts in Salzburg. He also serves as President of the International Writers Association “Bogdani”.



About the author

Mujë Buçpapaj, a famous poet and literary scholar, is one of the most prominent exponents of contemporary Albanian poetry, with significant national and international success. His works have been published in dozens of foreign languages, and he has been honored with several prestigious international awards. He is a poet, researcher, publicist, translator, essayist, and promoter of international literature and culture — a highly influential figure in the region and beyond. He also serves as a university lecturer. Dr. Mujë Buçpapaj holds a doctorate in literary sciences. He is the founder and editor-in-chief of the weekly literary and cultural newspaper *Nacional*, which is printed in Tirana and distributed in its print version in Kosovo, North Macedonia, and Montenegro. The online version of *Nacional* is updated daily. He is also the founder and director of the *Nacional Publishing House*, which publishes works by many distinguished international writers and poets. He resides in the capital city, Tirana, Albania, with his wife—a teacher—and their two daughters, both university students.

THE INVISIBLE VICTORY

Field of solitude remaining
Ripe corn
Sprouting from children's hands

Sun falling in marsh
Writing in vapour
Blowing wind

The girl giving in
In tall grass
Shrouded only by shadow

Love coming
From begging

Unspoken victories
Do not exist
But Harvesting
Is in forgetting waters

Life
Not enough
For Men

For Men
To do good

ANALOGY

In the morning
The horses remaining outside
The roofs
Woke up the village windows
With the clatter of wild hoof

Freed from night
The earth's old women filled
The houses with fires and wreaths
Of smoke
Warming the old clothes
Over the living breath
Down to the yard

Yards where they had first set foot as brides
Riding horses of winds
Woven for their first breeding
Kept in corrals of girls' imagination
Since the ancients made this village for children

With neighs of skies
From the grazed field
The horses returning
To reconcile the dreams

Their masters on the horseback
And men on their women

FLEEING MOMENT

An aphasic voice
A darkened wind
Meandering beyond the ingenuousness
of the shores and illusions
In the morning
Everything is illuminated
Even the very essence
Of embellishing the body

The legend cradled by perceptions
Failing amidst the ocean
The fear of the obscure loner
The denial of time
To stick to the routine
And displaying its craziness to adornment
The need to startle at dawn
By eluding the sun
Up till the sublime moment.



About the author

Hamid Larbi, a renowned poet and journalist, born in Algiers, who currently lives at Montpellier. He is the author of various essays and poetry collections translated into Spanish, Italian, Russian, Ukrainian, Romanian, Arabic and Serbian languages. In 1995, he received the journalism award from the Press Circle of Milan for “Giornalista estera” in Milan, Italy. In January 2018, he was awarded the International Poetry Contest, Concours International de Poésie, “L’amour de la liberté” from the European Academy of Science, Arts and Letters (EASAL) in France. He won the Silver Medal at the International Festival of Literature (LIFFT) in Baku (Azerbaijan). Member of the Movimieto Poetas del Mundo. He has also participated in various poetry festivals worldwide.



About the author

Araceli del Luján Lacore, an English teacher, poetess, and translator. She currently serves as Lecturer in Discursive Practices of Written Communication IV within the English Teacher Training Program in Higher Education. She is the author of three books: *El Viaje*, *Congreso 12-M*, and *El Tic Tac del Little Boy*. She has participated in the Festival La Juntada, organized by the Argentine Poets Association, and in the series *Suban a la Cúpula* at the Néstor Kirchner Cultural Center in Buenos Aires. From 2017 to 2021, together with Belén Villalba, she co-directed the literary series *La Bestia Poética* in Buenos Aires. Her work has appeared in numerous anthologies and literary journals worldwide. As a translator, she has rendered into English the poetry of Alan Jenkins and part of the anthology *The Whole Life*, (*La Vida Entera*) by poet and narrator Luis Benítez. She currently teaches English, works in literary translation, and collaborates with the cultural supplement of the Paco Urondo Agency in Buenos Aires.

STRIKE OR DIE

for Jacobo Fijman and the madwomen of the house

The cardinal's chest's on fire,
the rifle hidden in the femur
carries the name of a dog.
The mad see many things with clarity.
In the wasteland where they sink
fresh water waits for them.
They drink.
The mad don't hide their sorrow
they paint Victorian birds
huge heads, commanding
paint they paint and paint.
The mad see many things with clarity.
The sun drags its ray across the ear,
and traces the outline
of its own heart.
It sinks into the blood,
it couples with the arteries.
The mad bake bread in the storm.

CHRIST IN THE RAIN

How is it I can never find
Or call to mind
One image of Christ walking slowly in the rain
—Donald Revell

He pulls up the collar of his raincoat,
no hat, a few days' dark stubble, looking
at his likeness gleaming on the sidewalk.

From the resignation that lightly shapes his shoulders
I'd surmise he's coming from a meeting in the basement
of a church, more troubled than uplifted.

He looks weary, still in his thirties,
and the rain does not seem to distract him
from his longing.

I doubt the rain will ever tempt him
to forsake his faith, but you can't be sure,
you cannot be a saint without a body.



About the author

Juan Pablo Mobili, a famous poet, born in Buenos Aires in 1957 and adopted by New York in 1978. He published his first book, written in Spanish, in 1976, and did not publish his second book, written in English, until 2022. Although much time passed between books, he published over 200 poems in literary journals such as Tupelo Quarterly, Hanging Loose Magazine, Louisville Review and The Worcester Review, among others, as well as publications in Europe, Asia, Latin America, and Australia. He's also a recipient of multiple Pushcart Prize and Best of the Net nominations, and an Honorable Mention from the International Human Rights Art Festival. In January of 2025, he was appointed Poet Laureate of Rockland County, New York. In addition to this, professionally, he has been an organizational consultant, focusing on leadership development, for global business companies and non-profit institutions, for the last 35 years.



About the author

Armenuhi Sisyan, an important poetess, writer, playwright, professor at Yerevan State Medical University. Born in 1968 in Armenia. She is Author of 12 books. Her stories and poems frequently appear in top Armenian literary journals and published in different International literary magazines, anthologies. Her works are translated and published into 31 languages. Participant of various International literary festivals and programs (Vienna, Italy, Switzerland, Japan, Cyprus). She is winner of different Armenian and International literary prizes. In 2025 performed her own monodrama "To Kill and Forget" at the Armmono International Theater Festival with her own stage production and was awarded a diploma and a medal. She has done many translations of Anglo-American poetry of XX century, as well the poems of modern Japanese, Chinese, European poets into Armenian. She is Member of different International Writers Associations.

GREAT ABSENCE

The Great Absence is here again-
within me, round me.
Lord of Mercy,
lead me to the place
where I never am!

THE DAY

For all of those days
that I will not see,
today I will love you, day,
Will cherish you in my hands,
kiss you from bottom up,
warm you in my embrace,
and my breath, warm and dressed in words,
will reach those days.
But until you wave goodbye,
let me love you, day,
for all of those days
I will not see...

WHY LOOK UP WHEN THE SKY IS NO MORE?

Why look up when the sky is no more?
When I got used to this lifeless face.
Long, long ago, an Idea came to mind
And a pale sun, just hollow in form.
Why look up when the sky is no more?
When in the sky, now a sole eye is left.
Why look up when the sky long ago
Sank into the soil - look under my feet
A mere red stain, the sun is no more.
Why look up? Behold this dying tree
Bent to the ground. Not finding heaven, this bird, split in half,
Abandoned its flight and learned to walk.
Why look up when I've decoded
The dream that bothers me,
And a primitive thought, veiled in complexity
And when I eavesdropped on my soul,
I saw that heaven is left in us.



About the author

Naira Yedigaryan, a poetess, was born in 1978. She finished her degree at Yerevan State University of Journalism, studied in Pantomime Studio. Currently she has been working in Yerevan State Pantomime Theatre for 27 years as an actress and has played many roles. In 2016 she took part in "Golden Lynx" international theatre festival in Bosnia and Herzegovina and won "The Best Movement" prize. In 2017 she took part in "Living Faces" international theatre festival in Tumen and won "The Best Female Role" prize. In 2025 she participated in "Colombo International Theatre Festival" and won the "Best Director" prize for her play "Inside". She is a member of "The Writers Union of Armenia" an author of many books, poems as well as a playwright.



About the author

Les Wicks, a renowned contemporary poet from Australia, for over 50 years Wicks has performed widely across the globe. Published in over 500 different magazines, anthologies & newspapers across 39 countries in 17 languages. Conducts workshops & runs Meuse Press which focuses on poetry outreach projects like poetry on buses & poetry published on the surface of a river. His 15th book of poetry is *Time Taken – New & Selected* (Puncher & Wattmann, 2nd ed 2024).

This is the godguts of the land.
Like those grasses
we are somehow a part
yet simultaneously irrelevant & a threat —
our recording, our boots.

TERMINUS

In the struggle of happiness
it only hurts as much as it was worth.

I stroke your hair, get
that last response still possible...
a small smile, so different from your beam
back when there was a flow on.

Love has difficulties.
Unchosen suffering,
the extension.

We all have a centre
somewhere between those fences — onus & self-preservation.
From within that enclosure something
astounding occasionally emerges a cascade.

But there is now little more than a trickle
some stranger in your own frame
calmed above concrete laid so staunch
that “residents” can never tumble
into depth.

TO WATER

Predators like us know all about preservation of energy.
Background music — a drummer falls into his set the
ribbon gum has a hohum on—
sheds in sync with the birth
& beggary of spring.

We too tumble as we fumble
with bedsheets & nervepurrs—
that shack at the edge of the park
where Gynea Lilies engrave the sky.

Later we walk through paths
that kangaroos have made to water.
Sly imported grasses have homed themselves there
down deep beneath the ridge.
Beast & humans pass in edgy concord.
A few steps offtrack an echidna notices nothing but the feed.

Where

Where is the quiet,
yet steady sound of peace?

The sound of peace
even in muffled ears?

Where is the angel's harp,
which always plays its melodies?

Where are the tongues of angels,
which always speak about it?

Where are Noah's doves,
with the olive branch,

that once were received
with the greatest joy?

AT THE BLUE HOUR

When the sun
is just setting,
and almost everyone has gone away,

in this magical light,
sitting down somewhere, anywhere
in the countryside,

with the black-green
holly oak forests in your back
and the sea of longing before your eyes,

for the pomegranate trees
are blooming bright red,
the way love only bloomed in days past.

Even if you
cannot escape the leave-taking,
nothing that exists can disappear utterly.

For even
if you think about nothingness,
it is nothingness, no more.



About the author

Kurt F. Svatek, an outstanding poet, writer, born in 1949 in Vienna, lived and worked for nearly four decades in southern Lower Austria as a teacher, and then returned with his family to his native city. Including the translated books he has published more than 100 books of poetry, aphorisms, essays, short stories, haiku, and two novels. He is publisher of the anthology: Unser Europa (Our Europe). He has also has several papers on aspects of philology and one textbook. His works have been featured in numerous magazines and translated into more than 70 languages, and earned him numerous awards. He has been repeatedly proposed for the Nobel Prize in Literature and Peace by proponents from India, China and Italy and voted five times the best international poet of the year (2005, 2006, 2007, 2008, and 2012) by several literary periodicals. A symposium on his works was held in Bangalore (India) in 2009. The author has also been involved in various literary associations for decades as a board member and vice president.



About the author

Nargiz Ismayilova, a famous poetess, born in 1986 in Ordubad. In 2008 she graduated from Nakhchivan State University with a degree in “Azerbaijani language and literature”, and in 2012 from Ganja State University with a degree in “Literature of Foreign Peoples” with honors. Nargiz Ismayilova worked as a senior researcher at the Department of Literary Studies of the Institute of Literature and Art at the Nakhchivan Branch of ANAS. She is a Doctor of Philosophy in Philology, majoring in

“Azerbaijani Literature” and “World Literature”. She is the author of 2 monographs, 60 scientific, more than 400 newspaper articles, 7 fiction, 8 translated works. Nargiz Ismayilova was awarded the “Ali Bey Huseynzadeh Award” established by the Writers' Union of Azerbaijan and the “Literary Newspaper” in 2017. She was awarded at the IV Euroasian Literary Festival of Festivals (LIFFT) in Baku. She is a Presidential Award winner.

NOTRE-DAME`S SHADOW IS GOING PINK

Notre-Dame`s shadow is going to pink Every year on April, in Paris... Quazimodo and church`s deafening bell
Awakes Notre-Dame from his eight hundred fifty years dream Scratch Quazimodo`s fingers his chest
Shatters all her femininity
Notre Dame shames for his bareness Everyone has seen his body
Gems and tattoos on his spine Roses....
Everyone has seen the nudity of his spirit All has touched his lips
Cherry flowers and Notre Dame`s grayish loneliness Everything painted with Esmeralda`s lipstick
This year on April, in Paris...
Sena was proudly silent, didn`t wave Tired of his ships,
This year on April, in Paris...
Kisses was lost in corner of oldest bars, Notre –Dame was freezed on artist`s brushes
Smiles weren`t seen sincerely on Merlin Monro`s portraits This year on April, in Paris
Lusifer, send me please,
Let me pass over God`s love, Slick his hair...
Priest dreamt Esmeralda more than eight hundred years.
If the God damned Notre-Dame this year on April, in Paris? There was a call to sin on his body,
Did I sell my soul for him?... If God give me a chance
Did I break all my laws?
Cherry flowers and Notre Dame`s grayish loneliness Everything painted with Esmeralda`s lipstick
This year on April, in Paris...

About the author

Layla Al-Sayed, born in Kingdom of Bahrain in 1967, is a famous poetess and writer in contemporary Bahrain. She now lives in Bahrain–Alnasfa Village. She is a Teacher of Arabic at the Ministry of Education in Bahrain, a member within the Circle of Bahrain Writers and Editors, a member of Bahrain Cinema Club. She was the superintendent of the centre of conferences for the First Arab Cinema Festival which was held within the period from the 27th to 31st of March 2000. She has her own contribution in poetry in



Bahraini, Gulf and Arab newspapers. She has published 7 poetry books since 2003. One of her poetry books was published in English, Spanish and Deutschlanguages could (Who Inherits The Smile Of Me) published in 2005 before she travel to Columbia to attend International Poetry Festival of Medellin. Many of her pomes has been translated and published in several language (ex. English, Spanish, French, Deutsch, Dutch and Swedish).

THE DREAM

Yesterday,
I did split up the dream of mine.
While on the track of his, I was paring off what thereof should not be left.
While I was walking on,
I left behind the boisterous laughers of mine
And crossed the other quarter,
After I had stripped off the smile
And gone away with no poem,
With no love.
I then saw the body of mine,
Still suffused with lust,
I hence flang her about the threshold
And in I went
With no body
And I dreamt:
That the victims shall flock in on the eve
And count my sins against me.
(Translated by Husain Selmi)



About the author

Hassanal Abdullah, a renowned poet, novelist, critic, translator, and song writer, was born in Bangladesh in 1967, and immigrated to the United States in 1990. He completed his bachelor's and master's in mathematics at the City University of New York. Abdullah is the author of an epic on cosmology and sixty-one books in various genres, and the editor of *Shabdaguchha*, an international bilingual poetry journal, since 1998. Hassanal received four international poetry awards, including the Homer Medal (2016) and Paul von Heyse Prize (2024). He has been invited to international poetry festivals in China, Czech Republic, Greece, Guatemala, India, Kenya, Macedonia, Mexico, Morocco, and Poland. His poetry has been translated into seventeen languages. Hassanal's *Collected Poems*, in Bengali, was published in two volumes. He edited *World Poetry Anthology* and translated *Contemporary Bangladeshi Poetry* (Feral Press-NY, 2019). Abdullah retired in 2024 after 27 years of teaching mathematics and computer science in the NYC

INFERNO

I hurry down the stairs,
overwhelmed by desire
as I watch Dante's Inferno.
Crossing the boundaries of pleasure,
it urges me to go even lower.
I am elated;
my tears sway like moving images
rolling on a screen,
filling me completely.
Descending is much easier than climbing—
with the help of gravity,
something I've known for long—
yet I begin to sweat,
and I take off my shirt.
With bare chest,
I run toward my flaming destination.
As I descend further,
even my shoes tear.
I throw them off, and—how strange—
at that very moment,
my pants slip off on their own,
falling faster than me.
My last undergarments drop away too;
ah! I never had such primal freedom before!
Far, far below, into grotesque darkness—
right then I notice:
in the ninth circle of the Inferno,
millions of naked people like me
enter laughing, effortlessly—
to that grand festival of ecstasy,
I surrender myself
and descend even faster.

BEING AND NON-BEING

Is existence corporeal or incorporeal?

Does existence precede
Or succeed essence?

Existentialist Sartre says -
“Existence precedes essence”.
Then, the existence of my departed soul
Reasonably irrelevant.

If truth is temporal, and relative
Then, in the context of life and existence
Why would it be relevant?

“Sensory experience is the basis
Of knowledge that finds truth”
As said the Empiricists Barkeley
And others.

Hearing this my wife cried
As she is inevitably irrelevant now!
Similarly irrelevant spiritual values
And moral categories - humanity,
Nobility and honesty,
The forms of truth, goodness and beauty.

But life and the world practically exist
In the overall standard of truth,
Goodness, and beauty, where
Youth and past-youth emerge
As the shape of aesthetic feelings
In the context of generosity.

It is only a variation in the feeling;
A particular feeling of existentialism
In the same essence, my lover
In fact, remains truly existent.
Therefore, even in this old age,
I love my wife.



About the author

Shikdar Mohammed Kibriah, an outstanding poet, essayist, story writer, critic, and translator, was born in 1968 in Sylhet, Bangladesh, Masters in philosophy. He writes in Bangla and English. He is a global poetry promoter and literary personality, founder and president, Poetry and Literature World Vision. His basic books published are 21 so far. Among them ten on poetry, eight on prose and three on story. The last prose book is 'Philosophic Discourse of Poetry and Art' and the poetry book is 'Selected English Poetry, Volume 1'. Both are published by Prodigy Published, USA on Amazon. Shikdar is the editor in chief of the high profile encyclopedic anthology series 'World Contemporary Poets Vol.1,2'. His writings have been translated and published in 50 principal languages of the world.



About the author

Tasneem Hossain, a multi-lingual poetess, educator, fiction and op-ed writer, translator and trainer from Bangladesh. She has immersed herself in the timeless essence of literary creations since 2018. Born on 20 August. Tasneem's works have transcended geographical boundaries and have found their way in esteemed anthologies, journals, newspapers and international magazines worldwide. Winner of The International Literary Association Creative Tribune, Walt Whitman 2025 Contest, her poems have been translated in 14 languages. Publications: The Pearl Necklace, Floating Feathers and Grass in Green and Split and Splice. Several of her articles and poems are utilized as teaching material in universities and academies across countries; some have been referenced in university research papers and subject of research papers. A former faculty, she is the director of two Continuing Education Centre (Bangladesh). She has 28 years of experience as a trainer.

THOUGHTS OF AN IMMIGRANT

She stands in front of the canvas and stares.
Recollections of her childhood memories flash.
Her rendezvous with the flora and fauna of Sundarbans;
Her eye contact with the Royal Bengal tiger lingers on.

Ah! the breeze and nature's playful song,
Singing a lullaby to her innocent mind.
Down memory lane all comes flooded as in a dream:
The steamboat engine and the rough water tides.
Fifty years of separation from her birth country, she sighs.

Her paintings speak of her love divine,
Of a country that she left behind.
Visitors stare, praises abound;
Tears roll down, she is flooded with the pressmen around.

She smiles and gives a valiant look.
Now, in a far-off land, she resides.
She has not left Bangladesh, her motherland, behind.
Treasured in her heart, locked with a feather key;
Floating feathers of her past life, she feels free.

The meaning of her life she has found at last.
Life is full of echoes and contrasts.
Connected with the invisible cord
Life plays on different beautiful chords.

About the author

Ruslan Anatolyevich Pivovarov, a russian-speaking poet of Belarus. The author of poems, short stories and fairy tales, was born in Novomoskovsk, USSR/Ukraine in 1972, lives in the city of Lida, Republic of Belarus. The organizer of the literary online community “Poet’s Hall”. He has five published books of poetry. He has been awarded diplomas and medals by several international literary organizations. The author’s poems and prose have been translated into 15 languages (Arabic, German, Serbian, Belarusian, Turkmen, Vietnamese, Bengali, Azerbaijani, Hindi, English, Kyrgyz, Tajik, Turkish, Bulgarian and Ukrainian).



NOT WINTER IN SADNESS IS TO BLAME

Behind the clouds after sunset nothing you see
Why sadness to us do we bring?
It's not winter that's to blame for sadness
But the soul in the absence of spring.

The soul is often overwhelmed with rudeness
The stems of evil for sure do unfurl
It's not the fault of cold at all,
It's lack of warmth in the soul.

Fate is not enriched with pleasure
And the winds of loneliness howl.
It's not the blizzard of life that's to blame for,
But the soul's solemn downfall.

At times you have no return to broken feelings,
How much you may call happiness back...
And it's not pride that's to blame for
But only the soul that love does lack.
(Translated by Santosh Kumar Pokharel)



About the author

Jenny DeJager, a poetess, was born in 1951 in Belegem. Fifty years ago, her first poem was published in an anthology. Since then, she has published nine poetry collections and three novels. Some of her poems have been translated into English and Spanish. Her poetry appears in domestic and international anthologies. She studied language and cultural history for four years at the Open University in the Netherlands. She graduated from the Academy of Fine Arts in Ypres and then took three more years of drawing classes and one year of sculpture. Currently, she is taking a philosophy course at NHA (National Trade Academy). Her poems are presented in numerous poetry routes, including various locations in Bruges, De Haan, and Zelem.

WILD FLOWERS

Wild flowers wriggled among everything.
They meddle in smell and color
with the view off the garden.

At the end of the summer, they still have some chatter
And they swear they'll come back
more numerous than before.
They scatter, they want to be everywhere
And above all, somewhere welcome outside garden walls.
In their reserved place they live so close to each other,
that they can barely stand the smell of each other.
They come and go, crush each other.

In full bloom, they are rarely picked for a bouquet.
They adorn the garden but more often feel godforsaken.
It's the roller coaster of their lives.

About the author

Liza LEYLA (Eliza Muylaert), a famous poetess, translator and research worker, native of East Flanders (Belgium). After teaching French course in some secondary schools of Flanders, she came to Brussels to study Philosophy at the V.U.B. and in 1983, she had her viva (thesis) in philosophy about the thinking of the French writer Stendhal. In 1994, she started a linguistic project, Lingua & Littera, rendering services to universities, ministries, enterprises, private schools and private persons, continuing research work in philosophy about feminine myths. Liza Leyla began to publish in literary journals from 1981 on. Her poetry has been presented in Belgium, France and Spain, and

published in Dutch, French, English, Spanish, Provençal and Chinese. She has published over 30 collections of poetry, stories and translated poetry, and has won numerous international literary awards.



OCEANIC FUSION

The heady Waterfall
bursting into the butterfly night
at the flight of Pegasus
Birth of nostalgia
looking for OTHERNESS

The sprightly Waterfall
Moon and Sun vibrant
in oceanic fusion
Meeting of seagulls
encounter of centuries

Waterfall sighing
Black and White
in hearts-ecstasy
colour of the rainbow

Balkis, Queen of Sheba,
offers black sapphires
to King Solomon
The promised child,
Fruit of full moon night



About the author

Sulma Montero, pseudonym: Suyay, a famous poetess, was born in 1968 in La Paz, Bolivia. Her first book: Woman with dolls was published in 2007. Her key publications: 2019 - Addendum (intimate anthology) latin American Poetry Forms Collection. Argentina; 2015 - Serena (Novel, pre - selection PLI, Italy 2015); 2022 - Current Hispanic American poetry, in Greek; 2025 -The Solar wid. Contemporary poetry from Russia and Latin America, in russian. 2025 -Vibha project butterfly. Contemporary world poetry, in marathi, India. She has won several international literary awards.

LOVING SEASONS

1.

There is an enigma laden with fragrant bulbs
an illusion growing in the lake beloved by fireflies
slumbering fish drink the clarity of day
azure mountains celebrate their might of winds.
Upon the verge of a twilight where water grazes
the sidereal sailboat of my breath blooms
and on the fluorescent path of humid vines
I fall mute as I would confide to you
that something stirs within my veins
beside hundreds of springs.

2.

As long as you rise with a loving gaze
and play upon the earth with the purity of a bewitching animal.
As long as you smile in the company of one who has lost
and engage yourself in pursuit of an even higher aim.
If, all at once, you caress another being who harbors kindred abysses
and kindle the flame to remain standing despite everything.
The desert will blossom in yellow petals
and we shall see the unicornesses cross fervently
the summer of a dream that demands to be fulfilled.

3.

Take me in as evening falls this winter love
and inhabit the submerged thicket
upon the path of magical birds who shelter the ineffable.
Inspire the sway of azure blades within my pulse's deep
the vision that phosphoresces when it finds its magnetism in you.
Thus, while I love you, some cherry trees will bear fruit
and a violet landscape will uncover the secret of my dwelling
like a territory where the instant dawns in wonder.

4.

I long to lose myself in the murmur I hear as you speak to me
beneath the clear water that mirrors the sky.
Within that halo that sustains you and fascinates my shadow
which, on sensing you, disappears.
There is a premonition that overtakes me with a kindred joy
an inexplicable tenderness lit within the living fabric of love.
Perhaps it is the diaphanous presence of your nakedness
the motionless sparrows that await me in your pupils.
As it may be the leaf-tide of the adorned resting-place
in the luminous morning of an ageless autumn.

About the author

Ivo Mijo Andric, a famous poet, was born in 1948 in Bosnia and Herzegovina, in a small town called Canici. He grew up and got his primary and high school education in and around the area of Tuzla. During his student years, he moved to Sarajevo where he finished his BA in Political Studies and MA in Economics. He worked in various educational institutions, syndicates and governmental institutions of Bosnia and Herzegovina. From the mid-2004 he moved to Zagreb where he now resides and writes. He has published twenty poetry books for children and

adults, five novels and plays, two memoirs, seven books of essays and book reviews, and ten books of aphorisms and epigrams. His works have been translated to English, German, Russian, Czech, Slovakian, Slovenian, Macedonian, Chinese, Romanian and Armenian language.



THE QUESTION OF BEING

What to say to a bird
That leaves its nest;
What to say to a chromosome
Unveiling secrets?

How to bring dignity
To the poor old nest;
How to reveal to a gene
The existence of death?

Fall is not worthy of wings
Footstep is a mere reflection of foot
Tree rots without its branch
Poem is in need of word.

What to say about fog
That captures sight;
What to say about a seed
That lies outside its pod.

How to give back to the flower
What once was lost
When pollen is sterile
And bees fateful to drones.

THAT ONE THING

That one thing we are missing
Is called love, my dear
A drop of rain torn from the eye
Of a surprised cloud.

That one thing that keeps us apart
Is the pollen, my dear
Made by the bitterness
In the head of a sunflower.

That one thing that keeps aflame
Is the ray that falls
From the face of tired sun
That lives in heaven's nest.

That one thing that keeps us together
Is a thread that shines at night
With the help of electronics
From the Almighty Ericsson.

That one thing that blows us out
Is the candle in an empty grave
That patiently awaits for us
That offers us eternity
In the world under the weeds
In the world of the dead.



About the author

Jean Sartief, a poet, visual artist, and photographer born in Natal, Rio Grande do Norte, Brazil. He holds degrees in Business Administration and Social Communication, with a master's in Anthropology from the Federal University of Rio Grande do Norte. Sartief has published eight poetry books and contributed to various anthologies and literary magazines in Brazil, Spain, and Portugal. Currently residing in Porto, Portugal, his latest work, *Desrazão*, was released in 2024 by Editora Giro. His poetry is known for its sensitivity and depth, addressing themes like memory, LGBTQ+ identity, mental health, human relationships, and existential struggles.

MY HANDS

So i offer my clean hands
for you to sleep
to breathe with ease
unburdened by the ministry
of shattering blasts
alarms
the stifling scent of whispers

i cradle you
from all that strikes the earth and withers
from late-night nightmares
hosted by sleepless nights
from those who hide
by day offended and hollow
barren souls who point their fingers
with eyes as cold as loaded guns.

About the author

José Eduardo Degrazia, a distinguished poet, born in Porto Alegre, Brazil, in 1951. He is a retired ophthalmologist. As a writer he has published 19 books of short stories, poetry, novel, and children-juvenile. As a translator of Spanish and Italian, he published 14 books, among them, 9 by Pablo Neruda. Main Awards Received: Award of the Colonization and Immigration Biennium with Permanent Land, 1974; Contest Award from Status Magazine, 1978; Award of theater of the SNT with the play The house of the impossibles, 1975; 2006 The Best Translation South Prize with Pablo Neruda's books Book of the Year Award of the Gaúcha Association of Writers, with the novel The



kingdom of Macambira - 2006 Award from the Mihai Eminescu International Academy of Romania for the Work in prose - 2012. International Prize of Poetry of Trieste of 2013. Prize of Poetry of the Union of Writers of Moldavia. 2015. Translation Award of the Association of Publishers of Romania – 2016. Karamanov's prize of North Macedonia, 2022.

THE MOUNTAIN IS APPROACHING

The mountain seems to approach
and it walks towards your heart –
it might just be a matter of volume,
of leftovers, of concave and convex,
of veiled surfaces and recesses,
maybe the starlight
plays a game with the retina,
a movement that is nothing else
beyond the eternal struggle between Light and Shadow.

The mountain changes its shape being the same,
as the sunlight bathes it or leaves it.

The mountain seems to walk on the sunset
when the shadow casts shadows from the top.

The mountain seems to grow in the morning sun
when no dark stain blooms.

The mountain burns at noon all day
like a torch of stone, a beam of lava.

The mountain is not just granite, it is a scream. 小



About the author

Mihail Grigorov, a renowned poet, born in 1951 in the town of Sredets, Burgas Region, Bulgaria. He graduated from the Technical University of Varna, majoring in Telecommunications. He has been publishing poems since 1972. His poems have been included in over 20 poetry anthologies. He has published the poetry collections: “Between Stations”, “The Beginning of Love”, “Poems in Prose”, “The Statue of the Ship”, “Wings of the Seasons” and “Pagan Festival”. He is the winner of national and international poetry awards. His poems have been translated into Russian, Italian, Romanian, Chinese, Korean and English. In 2023, his poetry collection “The Blue Flame” was published in English in the USA by Caligirlbooks LLC. In 2025, Caligirlbooks

LLC published an electronic edition in Bulgarian of the poet’s latest book “Cosmic Wind”. Mihail Grigorov is a member of the Union of Bulgarian Writers and the Union of Bulgarian Journalists. He lives in Sofia.

I KNOW I WON'T GIVE IN

To Jack Kerouac

It—despair—sets me on fire,
it—despair—kills me,
when they push me against the wall,
when they break me down with questions
and ask me: Where's your money?
and they ask me: Where are your eyes?
and they ask me: Where is your shame?
and I remain silent, suicidal, mute,
and as for the money, my God, I don't know...
...I rise as if from self-admiration
cast down, humiliatingly interrogated -
and I have drunk and I have been rude -
and slowly reviving myself,
I know one thing: that I will not give in.

About the author

Raoul Djimeli, born in Baleveng, a Bamiléké tribe of Cameroon, in 1993. He started publishing poetry in 2011. He is now among the most important poets and critics of his generation. He has published collections of poems in Cameroon and in France. His poems are published in anthologies, magazines and revues around the world.



. Some of his poems are used in films like “Mother” the opening text of Ruth’s Story, a film on Malaria in Africa. He is the President of the Cameroonian festival of new writers & poets. He has organised cultural festivals in Cameroon and in Chad. His poems have received prizes and medals in France, Côte d’Ivoire and Cameroon. Raoul Djimeli is the Publisher of the Clijec Mag, a magazine of African literatures.

IF I SHOULD GO

if i should go
i will sing a song of joy
drink a cup of tea

and when the day spits
its dead bodies on the lips
of the ocean

i will sink again
drink again

the sun shines on the seashore
death snares the destiny of rats

and the poet, seated on embers
counts the waste and counts the waves



About the author

Flavia Cosma, award-winning Romanian born Canadian poet, writer and translator. Masters' degree in Electrical Engineering. Award-winning independent television documentary producer, director, screenwriter. More than 50 books. Her work represented in numerous anthologies. Flavia's book, 47 Poems, (Texas Tech University Press, 1992) received the ALTA Richard Wilbur Poetry Translation Prize (USA). Cosma's poetry book Leaves of a Diary was studied at the University of Toronto, 2008. Her poetry books Thus Spoke the Sea and The Latin Quarter were studied at Towson University, Baltimore, Maryland, USA, 2014 and 2017. Title of Excellence for outstanding contribution in the promotion and enrichment of the Romanian culture throughout the world, Festival "Lucian Blaga", XXIX edition, Romania, 2009; Colleen Thibaudeau Award 2023 -- Outstanding Contribution to Poetry (League of Canadian Poets— 2023). Flavia Cosma-- Director of the Biannual International Writers and Artists Festivals at Val-David, QC, Canada.

WITHOUT TRACE

The wild animal, less wild now,
lowers its head into my palms.
In a state of both dreams and awareness.
It forgets all worry,
closes its eyes, and lays back its ears.
Its small heart
doesn't start anymore at every rustle
of falling leaves,
or at the cold rain's beating drums.

A moment equal to eternity follows,
when all things are measured by the heart's pulse.
Then, shaking itself as if from a burden,
the animal leaves, undulating its slippery body
longwise and flatwise on the road.

Autumn swallows it
and leaves no trace.

RAIN BIRD

On the brink of your lips,
the transparently staying,
With a transparent color of a sky,
Is a memory,
Its lexis
Is my deferred rain from before,
In which your evenings shine,
So, I feel for it in infatuation with you,
I fall to pieces
Scattered around you in love,
So, you speared your gowns,
and gather me,
With the fingers of certainty, and defiance,
I see the sparkles of your bough,
conspicuous buds
Sweltering heedlessly,
Thus, arousing my ice,
That has been turbid for centuries,
Then, with care and affection,
I treat your ambers tenderly,
And advance on my trails,
pale and frail,
with paces
Inflaming other places.
Your plains stagger and fade away,
So, my limbs look around, flouncing,
leading me to you,
I reveal my innermost soul, and you veil me,
Your little is plenty,
In your eyes, I see tomorrow,
Vast in prospects, setting off to go,
Intertwined with me,
its wakefulness, is wilt,
That is apprehension-free.
Gasps harmonize,
With their hastiness, and ..., we flow,
A gush of tenderness,
And souls for the wind, this is your bird,
A little voyager,
Who didn't respond to your predilection in kind,
Her heart is hammered to softness,
so, she retreated,
Resorting to her pain, in fear and prejudice,



About the author

Yekthan al Hussainy, an Iraqi Canadian poet, was born in Hilla-Babylon-Iraq in 1959. He graduated from faculty of engineering- university of Baghdad. He left Iraq in 1995. He began writing and publishing in 1990. He has published five poetry books so far: The memory of the seasons 2010 in three languages Arabic, English and Spanish; I wave with a white heart- 2016-C.C.P.P.-Babylon-Iraq; Bracelets of Sorrow 2019 Dar Al-Darwesh- Plovdiv-Bulgaria; A Witness I wanted to be 2020: Al Furat House for Education and information-Iraq-Babylon; To Get the Clouds Back 2022: Al Furat House for Education and information-Iraq-Babylon. He worked as an engineer in Iraq, Libya, Canada and Qatar.

Pitfalls pour down,
to drag the tails of grief,
To the nonsense of grievance,
Burdens flow in without a sin,
Your yesterday has no day,
Its rat of suspicion is cunning,
and the cat of ache is daring,
My stepladders are not stepped on by your feet,
And the twilight of your winter,
Has not begun yet,
Now I see
I killed you,
And you killed me!



About the author

Alejandro Concha M, a poet and literary editor, was born in Lota, Chile, in 1995. He has published the books *Estirpe* (2017), *Los errores de nuestros padres* (2022), *Color a historia* (together with visual artist Jorge Torres, 2023), and *Salvaguarda* (2025). Founder of the artistic movement *La Balandra Poética*. Part of his work was selected for *Diálogos en Movimiento* of the National Reading Plan in 2023. He has served as a judge for the XV Gonzalo Rojas Pizarro Literary Contest (poetry category), the Ergo Poetry Plaque Prize in Peru, and the 100 cuentos para Baldomero contest organized by Fundación CEPAS. His work has been partially translated into English and Italian. His poems, short stories, and essays have been published in Chile and across Latin America.

OUR MACKEREL

I constantly visit you, mackerel,
And I find a dying voice in you.
It seems as if your bones talked to me,
commenting on the long road
of the dusty track.
A sharp voice running,
an echo inhabiting your desolation,
tells me of lost battles
of crucified martyrs,
idols... heroes...
and there is nothing I can say.
Nothing.

SONS OF THE ASHES

I wish that when you see the brightness
of the lights
you will not be blinded
and that you will remember that there was
a time in which you also were darkness

these ashes surrounding the feet
like skeletal trees
are the remains of the fire;
the starving figures of metal
are what we once were.

Son, I want you to understand
your powerful flame
as the living element,
lacking uneasiness
and flowing in the expansion of your existence,
and I wish that when you contemplate the future path
you will recognize inside you
the consummated carbons of the road.

We were taken,
lifted and thrown to the fire
cut in our childhood
burnt in our manhood
thrown into distress.

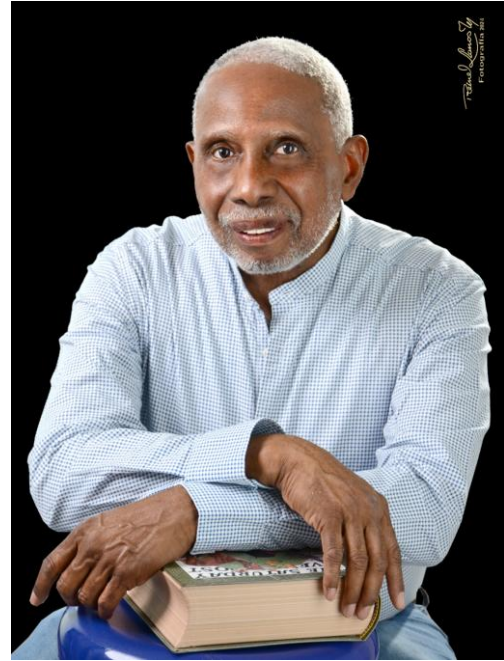
We will be ashes,
the wind will blow us away,
but still, deep inside,
we will not stop burning.

There is nothing that will serve as an excuse.

I am constantly visiting you, mackerel,
And I find in them a criminal repentance.

About the author

Pedro Licona (Pedro Adan Caicedo Licona), a famous poet and writer, was born in Quibdó (Chocó, Colombia) in 1948. He Current residence in Neiva. He has published *Journey on Foot to the Akasha* (poems), 1991; *Recipe to call Love* (poems), 2006. *7 and 45* (novel) 2007. *Landscape of Memory – Antioquia*. (poems) 2008. *The Touch of Time* (poems), 2009. *Sambapalo* (novel), 2011. *Crescent Quarter* (Poetic Anthology), 2010. *Time of Grace* (novel), 2014. *Let's Walk in this Body*. (Bilingual poems) 2019. *Rolling Uphill is Prohibited* (Bilingual poems), 2022. *Borders* (poems) 2024. *Guajira a landscape drawn in palm of hand* (poems) 2025. *Poetry of an immigrant* (poems) 2025. He has won several international literary awards.



LACK OF JUDGMENT

From a horizon of clouds, the sky falls,
Lavish justice, happy journey to the joyful waters,
who with their curly walk reach the dump.
From the silky floor raided by men,
the grey air rises, heroes of a thousand tasks,
increasing the humidity of the cloud,
the temptation to spill its joyful load,
that vivifies, cools, subdues temptation and the lack of judgment.

THE SENTENCES OF THE EARTH, THE SEA

To celebrate the distance between the humid, the corporeal, the gaseous,
there will be a cataclysm between the layers of the earth, the thin mud,
that closes an intention, an action, a word.

Thus the categories of love,
balancing the sentences of the earth, the sea,
without avalanches.



About the author

Rut Vargas Vivas, a poetess and writer, was born and raised in Bogotá, Colombia. She earned a degree in Political Science in 1992 and completed a master's in Planning and Development in 2000. She worked for a non-governmental organization and later served as an adviser to the President of Colombia before moving to the United States in 2002. In the U.S., she worked as a reporter for the Salt Lake Tribune and went on to earn a Master of Social Work (MSW) from the University of Utah in 2014. She currently conducts psychotherapy assessments for the Utah court system. Rut Vargas Vivas began writing at the age of 26, but it wasn't until 2022 that she published her first novel on Amazon, "Mala Prosapia," (The Lineage of Shadows). In 2024, she

released her debut poetry collection, "Mientras cae la Lluvia" (As the rain falls), marking not only a milestone in her literary journey but also a quiet triumph over years of silent creation. She has won several literary awards.

GREEN LIGHT

I see it ahead,
the traffic lights.
Green!
I speed up.

I don't want to stop.
I don't want to wait.

Red. Green.
Red. Green.
The light decides...
as if it knew
where I want to go.

No signs.
No destination.
Only the road.
And the urge to cross
though no one waits
on the other side.

STORM OF THE POET'S HEART

The sky, sad and swollen, wears a sullen mood—
Draping the horizon in a fathomless fog,
A curtain of rain draining the swollen clouds,
Dark cotton gathered, sealed and impenetrable.

Long wet hours fall in quiet spread,
Blessings the earth had long awaited.
Though the storm intrudes with brief unrest,
Its gift is sacred, its presence—holy rain.

Rise again, O sacred griot—
Move my soul, awaken the hidden fires.
Enchant me with your voice:
Tender plague, joyful deliverance,
A sweet intoxication, endless pleasure.
From you the lightning leaps—
From you all homage rises.

Is it a hurricane, a storm of words,
That shakes our quill and heals our wounds?
My heart withers with the first cold winds—
Suddenly the roses and dahlias vanish.

Vile November chill—see how my pen trembles.
Music falls silent; verses lose their notes.
I think of summer and sorrow stains me—
I become a butterfly, gliding over the Zambezi shore.

In the bright season, I watch the harbor shimmer;
Its waters satin-soft, I serenade them.
For in the poets' garden, it is always spring—
Music swells, words dance in celebration.

And when a rhyme blooms, a note is born—
A rose becomes a word,
A single rhyme—
a quiet fa rising into song.



About the author

Raïs Neza Boneza, a Congolese-born poet, writer, and peace practitioner based in Trondheim, Norway. His voice travels between continents, weaving memory, identity, and the wounds of history with hope and imagination. Through works such as *Nomad*, *Black Emeralds*, and *Eldorado blanc*, *fièvre noire*, *Lutefisk og Andre Dikt*, he writes of displacement, human dignity, and the fragile architecture of belonging. Boneza's work extends beyond the page—building bridges between communities, cultures, and diasporas. Guided by empathy and resistance, he uses literature as a form of witness, healing, and transformation.



About the author

Henry Vinicio Valerio Madriz, a poet, was born in Atenas, Costa Rica, 1969, is a teacher-English Teaching and Linguistics and Literature. Photography lover. He has published poems, short stories, and photographs, both online and print (in the USA, Canada, UK, India, Philippines, Pakistan, Germany, Palestine, and Israel). His works have been published in more than 35 anthologies around the world -collection of poems, a chapbook of poems, a collection of short stories in English, and a collection of short stories in Spanish are waiting for a chance to be published. Shortlisted in Voice of Peace: 1st Intercontinental Poetry And Short Story Anthology 2021, The League of Poets. He got an 'Honourable Mention' in Dark Poets Prize II, 2024. He is the Winner of the Literary Cocktail Magazine Enticing Shutterbug Award 2024 for photography.

YOUR EYES

In a two-sided exotic coin called the world
where both happiness and sorrow coexist,
where sanity and madness feed a hungry wolf
that restlessly attacks heart, mind, and soul...

...your eyes...

...feed my smiling breath with velvety looks
that transform into words of love that echo
(will echo for eternity) in the caverns of a life
that is asking for a permanent change to be filled by...

...your eyes...

...the ones I adore, as gods of light from ancient times,
to make our history run smooth and cheerfully
while hands are tenderly held, and kisses are sweetly scented,
to feel you, to feel me, to feel us, and everything around.

SMOKE AND INK

Yeah...
Another night in the shadows,
Another story dissolving into smoke.
I sit alone, the walls around me silent,
Poison in my glass, wounds in my heart that sting.
I wrote your name, but the ink runs—
Like tears on concrete, everything fades, everything is lost.
City lights extinguish my last dreams,
Fatigue tears my body, yet my thoughts still call for you.
Smoke from my lungs carries sorrow to the sky,
But I know you're not there; there's no us, no hope.
I watch the clock—time slips away like sand,
Nights grow longer, and days lose their shine.
Eyes red, soul cold as autumn,
You spoke of love, but it was only an illusion.
Look at me now—smoke and ink,
Everything I write vanishes like nothing, bro.
You said you loved me, but it wasn't true,
You are a shadow, I am pain, we are ashes.
Footsteps echo through empty streets,
I search for you in everyone, but all wear masks, faces
without stories.
My soul stands on thin ice—I break, but I endure,
A black flame in my heart, yet I still burn.
Glasses are empty, but my heart is heavier,
I've written verses for so long, but rhymes escape me.
No matter—let it hurt, let it last,
If a poem isn't a tear, then it's worth nothing, isn't it?
I watch the clock—time slips away like sand,
Nights grow longer, and days lose their shine.
Eyes red, soul cold as autumn,
You spoke of love, but it was only an illusion.
Look at me now—smoke and ink,
Everything I write vanishes like nothing, bro.
You said you loved me, but it wasn't true,
You are a shadow, I am pain, we are ashes.
Yeah...
Another night...
Another story in smoke...
I fade away...



About the author

Ankica Anchie, born in 1969 in Split, is the pseudonym of a Croatian author who began writing poetry and prose during her youth. Poetry has always been her refuge, theater a catharsis, and music the bloodstream of her emotions. She writes short stories, poetry, and texts that hover on the boundary between reality and the subconscious. Her poems, prose, and stories have been published in collective anthologies such as *Kultura Snova*, and in numerous journals and portals. After publishing her first solo poetry collections *Beside jedne Dalmatinke 1 & 2* (with reissues), *Kleknut htjedoh, učitelju, Grlom u jagode*, and children's collections *Zvezdana prašina*, she is preparing new poetry and prose collections, humorous works, short stories, and novels. *U tišini svitanja* – love poetry, prose, monodramas, stories, letters; *Novels: Ta slatka bol, 50 nijansi crne, Natalie*, autobiographical novel *Druga strana istine*; Children's collections: *Bajke, basne, priče i pjesme, Planeti fantastika*.



About the author

Lana Derkač, born in 1969, is a renowned Croatian poetess and writer. She has published eighteen collections of poetry, prose, drama, essays, and one novel. Featured in many magazines, journals, and anthologies in Croatia and abroad, her work has been translated into 23 languages. Her recognitions include national and international literary awards. Lana Derkač has participated in various literary events both at home and abroad, including the Struga Poetry Evenings, the Granada International Poetry Festival, the Stockholm International Poetry Festival... Her most important poetry books: Škrabica za sjene (The Chest for Shadows), Karlovac, 1999, poetry; Šah sa snijegom (A Chess Match Against Snow), Zagreb, 2011, poetry; Posvajanje neba (Adopting the Sky), Zagreb, 2015, poetry; Hotel za mrtve (Hotel for the Dead), Zagreb, 2020, poetry; Ugovor s prašinom (Covenant with Dust), Zagreb, 2022, (poetry selection); Azil za nebeska tijela (Asylum for Celestial Bodies), Zagreb, 2025, poetry.

THE CELEBRANT

The sky is a wizard.

It filled the plains with admiration, and they jumped into it
and from then on they defined themselves as mountains.

It impressed waters and following
the invisible threads of its most self-reliant
molecule they ascended into the clouds.

The sky listens well because it is an empty space
and no object obscures the sound.

It sees all movements because gridlock
does not halt the panoramic view nor does it
deprive it of objectivity.

The sky is wide and when a newly risen skyscraper
squeezes it a bit, pinches its lungs,
it is soon born at some other corner of the
Earth and it is a celebrant.
And so each day at some place it has its birthday.

The lights we turn on in the evening across the continents
are but boundless and erratic candles
on its birthday cake.

EVERGREEN

The snow is an architect.
On a redcurrant bush it designed mini hills.

In your humming every time it falls amply,
it has become an evergreen.

It has outgrown the pocket edition.
After all, you can find it everywhere in the courtyard,
it has filled to overflowing even the glass left unintentionally
to spend the winter outdoors.

The glass is at rest, it doesn't swallow it.
But it eats the glass on an empty stomach all the more voraciously.
(Translated by Ana Janković)

A MOLTO VIVACE EMBRACES ME

My mother is there
always attentive to my balance
and I see her pedal the morning
with which we scare away hunger
while in her laughter the days are drawn.

My mother is there
I only know that soon the girls will come
to try on the hours
that only she darns with her machine
when they knock at the door
and industrious she gets lost
inside the seam after the rain.

My mother is there
savouring the sesame
that still sprinkles her childhood,
and through her blue lips
a melody of Galician airs springs forth,
and she approaches the boy that I am
almost asleep beside her waiting,
and she recovers the tuning that time stole
behind the fleeting labyrinth of autumn.

My mother is there
it is I who am far away...very far,
cradling in the word
the molto vivace of the Singer
that on this morning...
embraces me.



About the author

Carlos Rafael Chacón Zaldívar, born in Mayarí, Cuba in 1958, is a renowned poet, storyteller, and critic. He is a member of the UNEAC (Cuban Union of Writers and Artists). He coordinates the Pablo Neruda Literary Creation Workshop, which brings together students from the University Matanzas. He is Doctor in Ciencias sobre Arte. Awards: Raúl Gómez García National Short Story Award, 1995; Valdemera Short Story Award, Spain, 1995; Assoluto San Valentino Award, Italy, 1998; Biennial Short Story Award, Matanzas, 2000; Hoja de Encina Award, Spain, 2002; Publio Virgilio Marone Award for Poetry in a Foreign Language, Italy, 2005. Published Works: Viejo buscador del agua (Cuentos, 1993); Cuentos de Noche buena (1994); Oratoria lírica por América (Ensayo, 1994); Ángel de mi guarda y otros textos (Poesía, 1995); Antología Cósmico-lírica México (Poesía, 2001); El caballo y las voces (Cuento, 2002); El retrato femenino en la poesía de Carilda Oliver Labra (Ensayo, 2004); Para un discreto naufragio, La Tinta del Alcatraz, Mexico (Poesía, 2004). Antologías Versos en el horizonte de la Isla (Ediciones Caronte, Chile 2016).



About the author

Rafael Bordao, Ph.D. (Old Havana), an outstanding poet, writer, editor, professor and Cuban exile. He studied Literature, Journalism, Psychology, French and Appreciation of the Plastic Arts in Cuba without graduating in any of them. He obtained two Master's degrees and a doctorate (Ph.D.) from Teachers College at Columbia University in New York. His poetic work has received numerous national and international awards. His poetry has been partially translated into English, French, Portuguese, Italian and Hebrew, and has been published in more than 60 anthologies and in numerous literary magazines in the United States, Canada, Latin America and Europe. His thesis After his doctorate at Columbia University, Reinaldo Arenas' Satire, Irony, and Literary Carnival in Leprosorio (Poetic Trilogy) was selected and published in 2002 by the North American publisher The Edwin Mellen Press. He is a member of the PEN Club of Cuban Writers in Exile, having left Cuba in 1980.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR A YOUNG POET

The first thing a true poet
should do
is rinse out his mouth
(prescribe himself garglings)
and put on the stablest
and darkest shoes;
then
begin to walk over the planet,
taking the pulse of each thing,
examining every respiration,
stethoscoping the sound of emotions
and always carrying with him a magnifying glass
as the most efficient amulet against
suspicious spirits;
then
sing, yes, sing, and not too loud
lest it offend some bird
drowsing on a branch
and he begin to squawk above your head.

HYMN TO FOLIAGE

Leaves whose frightened hearts suicide
leaves raped by the wind's impulse
here I am conjuring up my joyfulness
amid so much sullied innocence
beating with liberty
ecstatic with birds
filling my sorrows with vegetal health
here I am fennel-filled with a dream in hand
opposed to abandonment
satisfied and roving
invited by circumstances to philanthropy.

Leaves that refuse work and offer their bewitching aura
I love them
as I also adore
the raucous inspiration that moves me
I am pleading for them to drown my fate unanimously
and wrap my mistakes in dead leafage
I want to bleed my chlorophyll honor
I want to be those leaves that escape
and now nothing stops them
those that are falling...
absolved and purified.

WHEN RESPECT IS LOST

Provocation,
Leading to aggression,
A blast,
Will it be the last?

When Respect is lost,
And cannot be found at any cost,
Chaos will inevitably prevail;
Any peace effort will be of no avail.

Human turmoil will trigger,
Nature's rage, which is bigger!
Dead bodies and rumbles on the ground,
Added to nature's calamities around.

People flee to safety, if this can be found,
Nature splits the ground!
Refugees, misery and death;
Is human reason deaf?

Can't reason prevail and bring peace?
Can't everything remain in one piece?
Provocation can meet reason;
Good will in every season.

Respect for life,
And any human strife,
Must re-appear,
Then the sky will be clear!

Winter will be left behind
And aggression be kept out of mind.
The coming spring will revive earth,
It will bring life a new breath.



About the author

Rubina Andredakis, an outstanding poetess, writer and translator. She is Greek, Cretan, was born in 1948 in Moshi-Tanzania, East Africa. She has obtained several diplomas in four languages (English, Greek, French and Italian), and has acquired a BA degree in Journalism and Creative Writing. She has worked as an English teacher. Since 1992, she has done a lot of translations and has written quite a number of short stories, poems and articles. From 2002 her work starts being published. She is the Founder of RUBINI PUBLICATIONS, Editor/Publisher of the yearly magazine "Creature Features –The Ark of Writing". "The Man From The Shadows Of Idi" is her first historical novel. Most of her poems have been translated into Russian, French, Spanish, Portuguese, Romanian, Hindi, Sanskrit (Indo-Asian Literature Academy) Chinese and Swahili too. She permanently residing Cyprus, since 1970. 2016, she has published a multilingual Poetry Anthology, "A & 1 Is The Founder -50+1 Poems In 10+1 Languages". 2018, Poems included in the Contemporary International Poetry.



About the author

Niels Hav, a distinguished Danish poet, author with eleven published volumes. Widely travelled, his work expands beyond the boundaries of Denmark via references, influences, and themes. His new English poetry collection, *Moments of Happiness* is published by Anvil Press. Niels Hav was awarded the Danish Literature Prize 2024 from Ragna Sidéns and Vagn Clausens Foundation. His books are widely translated into languages including e.g. Portuguese, Dutch, Arabic, Turkish, English, Serbian, Kurdish, Albanian and Farsi. Frequently interviewed by the media, as he has travelled widely in Europe, Asia, Africa, North and South America and participated in numerous literary events. His poems and stories are published in a large number of magazines and newspapers around the world. Niels Hav was raised on a farm in western Denmark. Today he resides with his wife the concert pianist Christina Bjørkøe in the most colourful and multi-ethnic part of the Danish capital, Copenhagen.

ALL MY UMBRELLAS WERE BOUGHT IN ISTANBUL

All my umbrellas were bought in Istanbul
except the one I bought in Bursa.

Every time I go to Istanbul
I expect sunshine,
that's how I feel about Istanbul.

I forgive her –
in my mind Istanbul is bathed in sunshine.
That's why I end up standing in the rain
on Istiklal Caddesi
negotiating the price of an umbrella.
And the umbrella I bought in Bursa
I forgot in Istanbul.

There's something mystical about this,
I love those umbrellas.
(Translated by P.K. Brask & Patrick Friesen)

About the author

Poul Lynggaard Damgaard, born in 1977, grew up in Odder, and lives in Aarhus, Denmark, is a famous poet. His work appears in publications and anthologies world wide. He has participated in several International Poetry Festivals in the world, and his poetry has been translated to many different languages. He has been awarded a prize “Lyre of Orpheus” at the International Festival of Poetry-Orpheus, 2018. The International best poet of the year 2021. International poetry and Translation Centre, China. He has published Poetry Books: “Boks Sepia”, 2013, “Disk Habitat”, 2014, “Stedets

omvendte beklædning”, 2015, “Figurativ uniform”, 2016, “Vi bærer hinanden som frakker”, 2019, “Rejsens farver”, 2020. “Tid mellem kronblade”, 2022. “Song of Walls”, 2023. “Hjelm”, “Digte i udvalg”, 2023, “Stilladset i Padova”, “Fredløs i øjeblikket”, 2025.

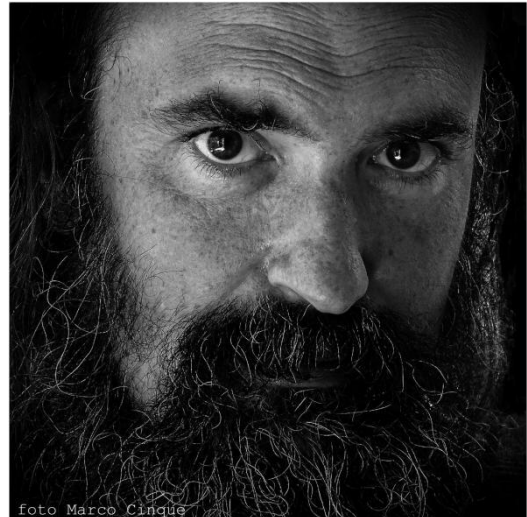


foto Marco Cinque

HILL OF HIDDEN LIFE

Triptych hides shadow.
Point sticks out under heron.
Bright field breaks off blind.

Surface of the lake
rips up darkness far away.
Ducks are coming close.

Forgotten facade vanish
asked for personality.
Icecold crack in cone.

Diving line allows
the dark ridge of a ghetto.
Kestrel still in air.

No way to go back.
Trolls and kings are forgotten.
Hill of hidden life.



About the author

Hanaan Abdelkader, real name Hanaan Abdelkader Ismail Ashour, is a poetess, born in 1964. She residence: in Kuwait. She holds bachelor of Arts and Education in Arabic Language in 1986, and postgraduate diploma in Education in 1989. She has been involved in the World Poetry Festival under the patronage of UNESCO. She is Journalistic Editor for several newspapers and magazines. Her poems have been translated into French, English, Spanish, Bengali, and Bulgarian. She has publications poetry collection: Do Not Let Me Leave - Poetry (1999); Dandanah (Humming/Melody) - Poetry (2000); Adnan... Come Back - Poetry (2001); Doves' Hearts - Poetry (2014); Rafif (Fluttering) - Poetry (2015); Grant Me 9 Words - (2016).

GRAY

For I am the gray, unobservant one,
 Half of life I live, half of life.
 Between me and the land is the breath of doom,
 Between me and the sea
 Are yearnings and water.
 And I am the gray,
 My whiteness is a disgrace,
 And the mournful black in my heart
 Is its call.
 Two faces in one face,
 A right side smiling for the light,
 And the lights are the breaths of prayer.
 And the other, the wearied one,
 Rough, scowling,
 Wrapped in sorrow,
 And his eyes pour down.
 And the heart is throbbing,
 Branching out, bleeding,
 Resting between the ribs,
 And its blood has raged.
 Two halves fight within my core,
 The right side did not return to me,
 Nor did my left side speak.
 I weep, and from my pain
 I embroider a bright smile,
 Whose beauty shines
 Above the lips.
 And I circle in an orbit
 Like a star that appeared,
 Gifting the splendor of light,
 While its two sides darken.
 My soul is scattered,
 I do not know for it
 A homeland to return to,
 Or a harbor of salvation.
 Stumbling between the paths,
 Spewed out to the wilderness, blindfolded,
 Its hands shackled.
 Wandering, raving with the truth, like
 The ravings of a drunkard,
 With no mind to guide him.
 The path is lost from the path,
 Nothing remains but the deceiving mirage,
 And the truth is lost.
 All good intentions conspired
 To drink the cup of death,
 To its end.
 And I am the gray, surrounded by my curse,
 I still live in life,
 Without life.

EXHAUSTED SONGS

I love you
Despite what I have
even though I don't care And I yearn for you
Didn't my play on my wound tell you?
That I'm madly in love with you despite my illness
But the longing is blowing me
I see the pain of my occupation
And if you have a thousand doors for the pains
A thousand passes through me
Ever since you left me without guilt
It's like you've been determined to fight me
I declared rebellion without excuse
Calms me down and relieves me
And my horizons are behind a dream.
My mirage of promises has seemed to me.
If I don't leave, I'm exhausted by my songs
She sings it with the cheeks and nights
And it carves both and the heart is a memory
You disturb me and displace me with imagination
And patience is worthless when I was patient
If we break up is beyond my possibility
And don't be tempted by what you see from me.
If the morning smiles on my article
If oblivion steals me at the time
And take me where I retire.
Only you live in the loins
Torture in my place and my journey
Indisputable madness and dignity.
And a miss that is cheating in my glory
I asked you with passion and kindness.
You increase the distance and do not exaggerate
So when is the meeting? And any lamination?
The bird sings in my shadow.



About the author

Sami Abubadr, an accomplished Egyptian poet, short story writer, and researcher in history and heritage, born in Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in 1975. His literary works have been published and translated internationally. He holds bachelor of Arts and Education (Arabic Language and Literature) of Al-Azhar University, Cairo, Egypt. He is Arabic Language and Literature Teacher of Ministry of Education – Egypt & Saudi Arabia. He has published poetry collections: An Hour of Night; Whispers of Streams; I Love You and Seek No Reward; Seasons of Absence; Harbors of Nostalgia. His poems, stories, and articles published in more than twenty Arab and foreign countries. Selected works translated into English, Spanish, Russian, Chinese, and Bengali, and Featured in several encyclopedias and poetic anthologies of contemporary Arabic poets.



About the author

André Cruchaga, a famous poet, was born in 1957, in Nueva Concepción, Chalatenango in El Salvador. He exercised the teaching for thirty-eight years. His poems appear in various magazines and anthologies in Spanish and other languages. “Estación Poesía, (Universidad de Sevilla, in Spain); “Un solo mare e la poesía” (Spanish and Italian language). “Dos naciones en versos”; “Segundo Índice Antológico de la poesía Salvadoreña”; and “Quizás tu nombre falte” (Anthology of Salvadoran poetry), Anthology “Poesía de Post-vanguardia”, 2018. “Al paso de los días”, 1ª., 2018; Antología Poética “Agua Dulce, Caracola 2018”, in Mexico. Dos naciones en verso, Cuba-El Salvador, 2019. Carlos Cañas Dinarte. “Diccionario escolar de autores salvadoreños”, 2019. Daniela Toma. DARE DE SEAMĂ, volum aniversar 5 ani Art Creativ, 2019. Poesis-Revistă de poezie și arte. Revistă finanțată de Ministerul Culturii și Identității Naționale Anul XXX (321-322-323), 2019. Monitorul de poezie. Revistă foileton, cu poezie de bon-ton, Anul 1, Numărul 9, 2019. Director Ionuț Calotă. Poesía de Post-vanguardia, II Antología, USA. Metáforas a través del mar II. 1ª. , 2019. Arjé. N5, Aniversario 1. Revista de literatura. 2020, etc.

GETTING DARK IN THE WINDOWS

Every roads are over, the streets,
and every trails at the end leads
to the top of the hill,
—that slows down
or find the same slope on the other side,
and it launches.

HILDA DOOLITTLE

Nightfall as an offense on the ship of the windows: it's as if the pillow consumed everything. Gray startles accumulate in the remote hours of nostalgia. (Those landscapes are true richness of the country, your breath of bad habits, that drowned roses on the asphalts of the future). I walk through a city with spent eyelids; before the dusk of mirrors at the west, it desire to drugs me when the wind of panties brush my body. Someone from the liquid of a cliff urinates beyond the horn of a nostalgia.

THE NOISES

the seashore, everything is narrow horizontal stripes, the world
reduced a few long straight lines that tighten,
between the sky and earth.

JOHN BANVILLE

In the long dream of coastlines, the photographs of sunset on the horizon. In a world out of date, like the broken mirrors of the deer, only the edge of terror, in the eyes whose scream, resounds in my heels. I resist the wandering loneliness of the sky, the abandonment of the dew on my feet, the ditches that were never a streetcar or window. (In this frightened land, I am content to imagine the dream you dream, or feel wherever we are, the breakfast of your terrestrial voice, or the platforms where silence laughed, or the droplets of your saliva, like a bird in your chest).

AN AFRICAN HAND

An African hand
has carefully shaped this wooden sculpture
almost 70 cm long, with two heads
and one body
two identical girl's heads, the eyes
closed now because,
because they can't see with them any more,
death has abducted the two-headed
goddess in its black armpit
goddess who never learned
to walk
but could speak, with her two mouths
words that were listened to closely
and also repeated to the next generation
the two heads spoke in turn
and one stopped to listen
when the other spoke, their conversations
would have become all the more interesting
and weighty and important
as soon as they would have realised that they were
a goddess we would call
Siamese
Siamese twins though Siam
is in Siam and far away
they predicted
the past and the future
like the dreams of aborigines
but they had been born
in the deep armpit of Africa unable to continue their lives
as gods
as gods
born for death unsuited for life
even though they were so well equipped
far better than ordinary people
with two boat-shaped mouths
four boat-shaped eyes,
two noses, baobabs growing upside down,
two sets of eyebrows like two horizons
in the east and in the west
two rose-coloured brains
like the sea's surface touched by sun going up and down
two coconut skulls
four labyrinthine ears



About the author

Anni Sumari, born in Helsinki, Finland in 1965, is a famous Finnish poetess and author with 17 books (poems, short prose, a travelogue) published so far. Her first book was published in 1986, titled "Matkakertomuksia pimeydestä" ("Travel Stories from the Darkness"). She works as a free writer and translator – she has translated into Finnish e.g. Samuel Beckett...etc, she has also edited several anthologies of Finnish poetry, translated into other languages. She has won several international literary awards. Anni Sumari has received 5- and 3-year state artist grants for the years 2004-2006, 2007-2011 and 2013-2015. Her poems have been published in literature magazines and anthologies in 25 languages, and her selected poems have come out in Slovak (Ars Poetica, Bratislava 2007) and in Italian (titled "Gli anni sui mari", Mimesis Edizioni 2022). Sumari has participated approx. 70 international literature festivals and worked in several international artists' residencies. .

two clavicles connecting
rivers of two throats
two shoulders
two hands
that wouldn't
greet one another
one heart
one belly
one womb
two feet
that wouldn't
step on the other's toes
(Translated by Sarka Hantula)



About the author

Marin Angel Lazarov, an excellent poet, writer, translator, photographer, journalist and project creator, was born in 1961 in Kazanlak (Rose Valley, Bulgaria). Since 1991 he has been living in Finland. His first book of poems was published in Bulgaria when the author was 17,5 years old. In total, the poet has written more than 1000 poems, many of which have been translated into 11 languages. M.A. Lazarov speaks several foreign languages and professionally translates (a total of 185 poets and poetesses) pearls of world poetry into Bulgarian, English and Finnish. However, his work is not limited to poetry, it is multifaceted. He has written fairy tales for children and adults, touching essays, many critical and review articles on various topics. For a series of interviews revealing humanity in man, he was awarded the Silver Pen of Russia prize of the international competition National Literary Award Pero Rusi-2016. In 2021 he was awarded a diploma of the International Academy of Literature, Art and Communications (International Franz Kafka Medal) for great achievements in the field of literature and communications.

VAGABOND

In the silence where the burning darkness rages,
The tramp's eye glides lonely,
Before the tender mask of deadly evil.
Gentle and wide open.
Far away, between the curves of long shadows,
His plea stretches to the sky,
Of hard rhymed words and ideas.
Between sounds melts blindly...
And here on earth the spirit rises high,
Abolishing the dead letter of truth.
But the gods of yesterday will catch up with him,
Roughly kneading a new flour...

CHAOS

The ruthless jostling with slithery palms
on a bloody collapse.
The role of an idiot who's got it-
He'll never be allowed
To the world of sensible.
The palms are suffering.
The shades fall down
With amorous delay
Under transparent light.
The faith
And its lechery
Take wing
Towards the south.
Or north.
All the same to me.
The sun is shining.
Scarlet scales
Which have got the blood from a red fish's
Wounds.
The white from a variegated painting
Forgotten after the rain
Is always deceitful.
The wind-
A dangerous silence-
Mixes everything.
We've got
Chaos of impossibilities.

ODE TO ISIS

Unique Isis, full-faced sorceress
Daughter of Joy, mother of Paris
I pray in your name a thousand praises
I pray to your majesty,
from cloudless skies
Drive the haughty gods to Hell.

I pray for the flower-tattooed home
that it resound with the trilling of birds
when unbound Dawn dwells there again,
I pray to reveal the intense secret
Of your heart whose blood runs in my
very veins.

Egypt! Egypt! your song stumbling
against city-lovers' bodies,
the memories of our countries
covered by those
Worshippers with sonorous voices
Who ceaselessly dance the voyage unceasingly
from your birthplace.

I pray to the dark-eyed helmswoman
the Lorelei wearing a double Crown,
her black hair & the serpent sprung
from her forehead, oh fulgurate Ankh
that she may receive the Golden Fleece.

I pray in your name, enriching my shore
& to the moonlike nacre
of the green sistrum
to calm my amber-yellow soul to reign
bedecked in calm linen garments
tightened around the dazzling richness
of those banished from joy!

Oh woman of fire, defy the Pariah!
Return to where the Parched one lingers
in her armor that terror encrypts, Come
free the temples of the sad virile fires
hardened by a restive body's
extinguishing thrill.

(Translated by John Wander)



About the author

Camille Aubaude, a famous poetess, was born in Paris, France, in 1959. Having created the poetic myth of Isis at the age of thirty, Camille Aubaude traces the mystical origins of poetry. Thanks to the numerous translations of her work, Camille Aubaude holds a vital place in world poetry. She is regularly invited to international poetry festivals. She followed this with a series of poems whose harmony contrasts sharply with the harshness of the intellectual and commercial milieu. Her journal, *Le Livre de l'Heure* (The Book of Hours), illustrates the genesis of a body of work that slowly emerges from its own darkness.



About the author

Antje Bothin, a renowned German-born poetess and author with an academic background who lives in Scotland, United Kingdom. She is a member of City of Poets Glasgow and the Federation of Writers (Scotland), and recently received the Impactful Creative Voice Award. She published her work in several books, anthologies, journals and e-zines. Her poetry is featured in a contemporary anthology called “Blotters’ Jotters” and in the Taj Mahal anthology as well as in an anthology with the title of “Immortal

Hymns”. She has a passion for writing poetry about nature and wellbeing and published amazing poems in magazines such as “The Globe Review” and “Flash Fiction North”. She also published a novel, “Annika and the Treasure of Iceland”, and the poetry book “Quiet: A Poem about Selective Mutism”.

ENERGY IN MOTION

White foam mimicking snow
Constant quiet movement

Waves dancing happily in circles
Forming a twitching net of joy

Naked trees, patiently waiting
Their branches’ mirror images in the water

A shiny glow on the surface, festive vibes
Go with the endless flow

Swans, ducks and lots of fish
Enjoy the vibrant ride

As the water flows bravely on and on
Seemingly aimlessly but towards the sea

The river is alive
Pure energy of nature

About the author

Natalie Bisso, an outstanding modern poetess, novelist, essayist, and songwriter, was born in Crimea in 1955, and lives in Germany. She is the author of 13 original collections, more than 150 songs, and a co-author in more than 200 international anthologies. She is published in newspapers and magazines around the world. She is published in newspapers and magazines around the world. The poems have been translated into 45 languages. She writes in Russian. She has been seriously engaged in poetry since 2008 and immediately began to publish. She was awarded the title of "HONORARY FIGURE OF WORLD LITERATURE AND ARTS" with a silver badge. He participates in the literary life of different countries. Founder and President of the International Literary Association "Creative Tribune" (ILATT / ILACT). She has more than 400 Diplomas of the Laureate and Winner of competitions, and multiple literary prizes. She is a recipient of many orders and medals, including those under the auspices of UNESCO.



STAY HUMAN

Different roads lead us to this world,
Judas also passed his way in the world.
To be born a human is a miracle,
To remain a human being is work!

Without having time to read the whole prayer,
You become a target, as if in a shooting gallery,
Stay a man in a sinful world,
Where a shot in the black is the norm or revenge.

But everyone is free to choose their own path,
to live with dignity, with love and for the good,
Carry your cross without jumping and with courage,
To breathe deeply, without being afraid.



About the author

Osman Abraham Lincoln, stage name is Lincoln X, alias Kwaku Aman-ahu, is a born Poet, Spoken Word Artist and genius Writer from Kumasi – Ghana. Osman Abraham Lincoln is National Award Winning Spoken Word Poet in Spoken Word Poetry Category of Ghana Association of Writers (GAW) Literary Awards in 2022/23. Lincoln X has done Spoken Word Poetry Album, a new genre; he himself created and called it ANONWENE, the title of the Album is DANTABAN (THE CIRCLE WITHIN CIRCLES). Some of His Poems, Articles, Essays and Works are in prominent World Anthologies with International Poets, Academicians, Scholars and Thinkers around the World. Osman Abraham Lincoln is recently featured in WORLD POETRY YEARBOOK 2024, published in Cyprus.

THE MAN KWAME NKRUMAH

Verse 1

The MAN of the Spheres, lives in mystery
His shadow is here, stirring the waters in victory
The spear that penetrates every territory
The lions fell into a spell by His oratory
The feet adorned with destiny and fate of poetry
The brain that stirs the minds as monk in monastery
On the mission for history—
His Throne was buried in the strangers' cemetery
The people's ears are deaf and dumb in misery
They could not hear the mellifluous voice from Conakry
Ages appears and disappears in circles of geometry
The same hands hails Him the MAN beyond century.

Verse 2

The cockroaches fears the mere crumbs of His illumination
Which outshines on their filthy faces with imagination
This is the night-seer, in frozen ice;
Counted all the countless stars in the skies
What hand can bloat the MAN from the golden scroll?
Even His breeze makes Clio to roll
Blockheads are scared by the scarecrow
Neophytes can write their diatribes on the snow
But the dry land cannot stop the baobab tree to grow
Deities worshipping at the feet of the hero
He made the clouds wept and all the gods became tyro.

Verse 3

His manhood gave birth to the reincarnated Ancient Kingdom;
That made the other Man prophesied in the tomb:
“The Birth of a New Nation,” thus spoken the wisdom
The age of the times crumbles the bomb
The hour reveal the coming event from the womb
These are nights to keep vigil as owl at watch
But not to sleep on the couch
The visionaries living now, fan the torch
The blazing torch He left for us to watch
They could not hear the mellifluous voice from Conakry.

WRINKLES IN THE COFFEE

I wake up
Hearing the same sound
Every morning
Full of broken questions

With so many wrinkles in the coffee
With the same poem nailed down
In my mind again

I search for a word
I mourn
Even though I forgot to cry
So many nights
Away from you

I complain as always
Without a reason
When you're close to me

EARTH' S SWAN SONG

Our house in a desert
Without the garden's green
Trees out of ashes

We are thirsty and drowning
Without pollen the spring
Winter without snow

Woke up, we're old
In the sky our gaze
On the ground, always alone

The sea filled with plastics
Dies without dreams
Tomorrow looks for hope

A child like a moon
Illuminates our minds
Being right makes us angry

A thousand deaths darkness
Nightmare that deludes us
Earth's swan song



About the author

Dimitris P. Kraniotis, a famous poet, was born in 1966 in Larissa Prefecture in Greece and originates from Stomio (Larissa) where he grew up. He studied Medicine at the Aristotle University of Thessaloniki and obtained a Master of Science (MSc) in Medicine at the University of Thessaly. He lives in Larissa (Greece) and works as a medical doctor (internist). He is the author of 11 poetry books in 7 languages and the Editor-in-chief of an international anthology in English (205 poets from 65 countries). He has won many international awards for his poetry which has been translated into 37 languages and published in many countries. He has been invited and participated in many International Poetry Festivals. He is Doctor of Literature, Academician in Italy, President of the World Poets Society (W.P.S.), President of the International Chamber of Writers & Artists (CIESART) in Greece, Director of the Mediterranean Poetry Festival (Larissa, Greece), Chairman of the Writers for Peace Committee of PEN Greece.



About the author

Martha Vaskantira, a poetess, was born in 1977 in Greece, at the city of Patras. She studied Philology and Philosophy. She is involved in theater and music. She appeared in letters in the year 1996 with the publication of poems in literary magazines. A total of ten of her books have been published. Six poetry collections and four fairy tales. In 2022, she won first prize for writing the theatrical monologue "Peace and the Child" at the International Peace Cultural Olympiad held in Delphi. Some of her poems have been translated into English, Spanish, Turkish, Arabic, Hindi. Polish, Albanian, Korean and in Italian. In 2022, the newspaper "Peloponnisos"

proposed her to be a candidate for the persons of the year 2022. In January 2025, she was awarded 1st place in poetry, in the Greek category, in the International Literary Competition held in Kazakhstan in poetry and prose, in various languages.

ETERNAL LOVE

Captive daughter, eternal love
naked hugs, tied seas.

The night is crying,
words sanctified,
our years are winters,
they grow old sadly.

Darkness spread
on deserted roads,
moon which was saved,
the hope on the shoulders.

The gates will open,
before the gaze darkens
and the streets will fill
stars of the guerrillas.

They will sow love
that blooms with blood.
They will take the seeds,
the hands of the world.

WINNERS WE ARE

Lethal lies flagellating in the hot sun
 Burning at high noon from the northern winds
 Burst into a frantic dance
 And the rattle of death drums
 And nature singing softly, mourning
 For the brave rainbows we have killed.
 White feathered blue beak birds
 Peel off the pain from Mother Earth
 Torrential rains washing away
 The hardships and the grime
 And naked she was left.
 Our Homeric moonless nights far gone
 When moulding dreams,
 How many times did we flirt with death
 Nightmares and thunderstorms we've escaped.
 Take off the ancient masks of tragedy
 Walk bare naked with thy truth
 For we are destined to be free
 Break the chains of slavery.
 No more wars, famine and tyranny
 For you, are Free.
 I give my lungs to you, to breath
 Let your heart open so light can flow
 And Love to grow
 For only, with the eyes of the soul
 One can see, that with LOVE
 We are all One and for Eternity.



About the author

Nina Alexi, a renowned poetess, writer, essayist, instructor of theatrical education, is Greek. Born and grew up in Germany. She lived in London for eleven years, studying Performance Arts, theatre, creative writing & dance with a British government scholarship at Middlesex Polytechnic, at WAC Interchange, Associated Guild of Dance & Drama, Chantaine School of Dance (1981-1990), etc. Her published work with prominent publishers: (2003-2025), poetry collections, (Alexandria) theatre plays, (Dodoni), essays on theatre, (Herodotos). Her poems are included: "Encyclopaedia of Modern Greek Literature", "Greek Women poets of the 20th Century", "Contemporary Greek Poets", "Encyclopedia of Letters and Arts", "Encyclopedia of World Poets Association", "European Women Poets", anthologies in Greece and abroad. Awards: 1st prize for "Pontiac Mother" Athens, Medal "Poets for Peace", (Tunisia), Medal (International Society of Greek Writers) for her contribution to Letters & Arts, "International Best Poet of 2022" (IPTRC) Voting International Executive Committee (China), the "Aizu Taro Prize of World Gogyoshi" (4th anthology), (Japan), etc. Her poems have been translated in several languages.



About the author

András Petőcz, born in 1959 in Budapest, is a famous Hungarian poet. He has published around 55 books, including poems for adults and children, essays, fiction and reviews. His volumes of poems have been published in Hungarian, English, German, French, Bulgarian, Portuguese and Polish. He has been invited many times to visit countries such as the United States, France, Belgium, Portugal, and Austria, where he engaged in creative and cultural exchange activities. He has received the following important awards: 2017: Hungarian Laurel Wreath Award; 2010: Knight's Cross of the Hungarian Order of Merit; 2008: Sandor Márai Prize awarded by the Hungarian Ministry of Education and Culture, for his novel *Idegenek* (Strangers); 2006: UNESCO-Aschberg Laureat; 1996: Attila József Prize by the cultural part of the Hungarian government as an official recognition of his work to date; 1990: Robert Graves Prize for best Hungarian poem of the year 1990; 1987: Lajos Kassák Literary Prize.

OLD AND COLD, THE TWO GOOD FRIENDS

Old and Cold,
they were friends.
Not so close,
just hand in hand.

„How are you?”,
asked the Old.
„I am fine,
but have a cold.”

„And how are you?”,
asked the Cold.
„I’m fine too,
just have an old.”

And they were walking
hand in hand,
Old and Cold,
the two good friends.

A BANAL POEM, SUBJECT: LOVE

(Banális vers a szerelemről)

Those we loved, they’re dead.
Faces behind hands, shy
shawls dropped, modestly awry.
Those we love, they’re married.

Those we loved are busy in the kitchen.
Darkling hair heavy as a cross of flowers,
yet weightless. On you their gaze lowers.
Those we loved are bearing children.

(I wait for you in silence, without pain.
My back to the border, on a clattering train.
You caress your hands with mine.)

(You put my lips to yours. Kiss your lips with mine.
Demonstrations asleep, songs asleep too.
Those we loved, they’re dead too.)
(Translated by Jascha Kessler)

About the author

József Bíró, a renowned poet, writer, visual artist and sometimes editor, was born in 1951 in Budapest. He has been writing since 1975 to present. He is a member of Hungarian Alliance of Writers, Art Foundation of Hungarian Republic, Belletrist Association, Nine Dragon Heads International Artist Group – (South – Korea) , etc. He has published works : 41 books and booklets in Hungary and other countries (1986 – 2025), and won Hungarian Gold Cross of Merit, Recognition of Artistic Ouvre, Attila József – Prize.



LAND ART

'mong rain – beaten grassblades
- far as he can see –
surrounded by
blood stained cotton wads

on the lake's quiet surface
tiny flames flare

tiny flames flare
on the lake's quiet surface

blood stained cotton wads
surrounded by
-far as one can see -
'mong rain – beaten grassblades



About the author

Kamalakar Bhat, a Professor in the Postgraduate Department of English and Research Centre at Ahmednagar College, Ahilyanagar, Maharashtra, India. A bilingual poet and translator working across English, Hindi, Urdu, Marathi, and Kannada, he has published four Kannada poetry collections: Churuparu Reshime (Silk Shreds, PUTINA Award, 2006), Mugiyada Madhyahna (Endless Noon, 2010), Jagadajate Matukate (A Chat with the World, 2017), and Valase Hakkigala Huyilu (2025). His translations include Marathi poet Namdeo Dhasal (2018); the anthology Akkapakkada Pataragitti (The Neighbourhood Butterflies, 2021) from ten Indian languages; co-translation of Hemant Divate's Nakali Digilu (2024, with H. S. Shivaprakash); and Kannada translation of Ashok Vajpeyi's poetry, Ee Lokdologina Ananta Lokagalu (2025). Bhat's translations appear in journals including Indian Literature, Muse India, and The Bombay Literary Magazine.

BORDERS, DRAWN IN THE DUST

At the horizon,
a blade of light slices the rice fields,
redrawing the map,
erasing borders drawn in the dust.

I kneel by the water,
my reflection is multiplied in ripples.
Who drinks first?
My face answers: dissolved.

In the sky,
a flock of birds becomes a question mark;
then as they scatter,
their shadows rain down in fragments.

I hear the earth breathing,
its lungs filled with fragrant flowers,
crushed leaves, radiant soil.
I shudder, awakening from reverie,
with the sound of doors opening
and closing at once.

You whisper a name,
and the wind swishes through the areca nut orchard,
scattering cardamom's scent across the hill,
through the pages of burnt deeds,
through the hollow of a hand
that counts the weight of work hours.

Between us,
an untended mango orchard;
its branches heavy with fruit
neither you nor I
dare to claim.

NO SUICIDE

Please don't commit suicide
Which is not a solution of a guide
When the thorns of life chide.
When the thunderstorms come to the sky of your mind,
Think calmly
Think simply
Think yourself
Love yourself.

When you see all are dark
Look at the generous starry sky
That sometimes becomes dark
And faces thunderclouds high
Be patient
The weather is changeable
Like drought, wait for the rain
You will gain success again.

Please don't commit suicide
Although you are alone.
Keep in mind,
Loneliness is a boon
Which helps to know yourself soon.
Keep in mind,
Life is dark light.

Past is no more,
Future is too far away from your door.
Now you have a stony heart.
Fly in the every moment like a bird.



About the author

Md Ejaj Ahamed, a famous bilingual poet, writer, journalist, translator, editor, and teacher. He was born in 1990 in Murshidabad district, West Bengal. His educational qualifications are English Honours, triple MA, B.Ed. D.El.Ed. He has taught in a few private secondary and higher secondary schools and coaching centres from 2008 to January 2024. Then He has joined a primary school under West Bengal Government on February, 2024. His poems have been translated into 23 languages. He has made 'Ejajan Poem' and 'Science Poem'. He edited 4 anthologies - 'Kabitar Akash' (The Sky of Poetry) and 'Kabitar Aranya' (The Forest of Poetry), 'Kabitar Sagar' (The Sea of Poetry), 'Antarjatic Dwivasik Kabya (International Bilingual Poetry)' which he has also translated into Bengali. He is the chief editor of Swapner Vela Sahitya patrika (The Raft of Dreams Literary Magazine). He has gotten many awards.



Molly Joseph (Pen Name: Myna), a renowned poetess, writer, was born in 1956 in Kochi, Kerala, India. She is a professor, English, Retired as HOD, English, St. Xavier's College, Aluva, Kochi. Served as Professor, Communicative English, FISAT Engineering College & Business School. First Book was published in 2013. Had

About the author

Travelogues, Poems and Short Stories (for children also), has published 21 Books of Poems translated 2 novels and published two story books for children. Dr. Molly Joseph attends the SAARC and BIMSTEC Literary Conferences, Literary Meets, and World Congress of Poets. Two of her books were released at the reputed KISTRECH International Festival of Poetry in Kenya, Africa conducted at KISII University by the Deputy Ambassador of Israel. At present she serves as the Director, International Academy of Ethics.

SOMEWHERE

Cutting across the shards of despair and gloom
the sky clears up slow,
hope augurs...

somewhere
braving the bombing,
people rush in to grab the injured,
as saviours of rescue, peace...

somewhere,
urgent conclaves set up,
to settle the war on bargained peace...

somewhere
people stand and hug around the tree,
not allowing it to be cut,
not allowing the hill to be razed...

somewhere
sensible governments act,
put the leash on corporate greed...

somewhere
in Norwegian Labs,
a Seed bank is set up
to save earth if it grows sans vegetation...

Somewhere
scientists work on exploring an alternate earth...
somewhere
on river banks and ponds, frogs croak and croak...
poets, thinkers, writers, humanists,
croak and croak for good sense to prevail...

Somewhere
kindness oozes and drips,
when they at warfront, stop it for a day,
hug each and extend
greetings. of the special day...

Hope not a far cry
Bombshells stop for bird cries...
nature pristine and clean,
the thunder and darkness
the precursor of an enlivening rain
about to fall...

About the author

Soumna Dasgupta, a poetess, was born in 1967 in Jalpaiguri, West Bengal, India. She began writing poetry in 2003, quickly emerging as a distinct voice in contemporary Bengali literature. She has published books of poetry: *Ved Payaswini* (2006), *The Play Fair* (2008), *Song of the Grape Fruit* (2008), *Waves and the Signals* (2018), *The Zipper Will Stay Pulled Up* (2019), *My Blind Light-Bug* (2019), *Dialogue of the Snake and the Staircase* (2021), *Path of the Sun Harlot* (2022), *Selected Poems* (2023), *Songs Leaning on a Crutch* (2023), and *Toward the Solitary Monastery* (2024). In 2008, she received the prestigious Krittibas Award for *Ved Payaswini* (2006).



KNIFE

This sleep has been drugged
This sleep has been knifed
Relentlessly stabbed
Yet it does not bleed

The last address is now a missing link
It hangs in our yard
Tomato fields
Bleed one last time

They drench all flags
(Translated by Twisha Dasgupta)



About the author

Rini Asih Sasami, pen name Rini Valentina, is poetess and translator, was born in Weleri, Central Java, Indonesia, in 1971. Since childhood, she has loved reading and writing. Her writing talent was evident at a young age, but she began to take it seriously in early 2018. Her first book “Poesia de Amor 3 Continentes” was published in Farha Pustaka Indonesia in May 2018. Presently, Rini has published 25 books of poetry and short stories, including a translated book. A book of hers entitled My Heart is in Poetry Dream of You has been translated by Prof. Milutin Djurickovic into Serbian and was published on 2020 until she received the International Award Princess Noble Poetry Skills. Her literacy activities are not limited to her own works; she actively encourages dozens of global writers and poets from various countries to compile dozens of poetry anthologies in to Indonesian, English, and Spanish.

MOSS

Moss green
 Become a silent song
 Flowing over the silent embankment, only the grass dances
 Shooting the dusk, at the power of arrogance
 Then the moss was the same as before
 Dark green...dark green...
 Talkless
 Just green
 Huddled in the lake
 Verses of Psalm 23, about the Shepherd
 Ah, a body and soul
 God's steps have been ringing
 simple....
 In the middle of a busy world
 My soul rests on His staff
 Fear nothing.

THE MAN BEHIND THE OCEAN

At the edge of the calm ocean waves
 The sun invites the clouds gently
 Taking the horizon that speaks deeply to zero point
 His gaze was as white as foam, as he walked with a hesitant step.
 I want to explain everything in order.
 Why does he sleep among the waves?
 Even letting out a soft cry.
 Dolphins' song
 Carrying him to the middle of the ocean
 Still silent
 At the edge of the calm ocean waves
 Feeling strange in the clutches of sea eagles
 That man...
 Bare-chested and tanned, laughing with eyes as big as glass marbles.
 They are nothing
 Friendly waves in the ocean
 Even strong gusts of wind at dusk
 Just expensive entertainment for which one need not pay.
 Because...
 Tall man with long, powerful arms.
 Spreading the old net, widening a curved smile,
 as beautiful as the crescent moon in early December
 A powerful man with his chest bare.
 He stares at the sinking wave.
 I want to go home, guided by the dance of the dolphins that guide him.
 Until the lips of white foam burst,
 He greets the rocks at the corner of the reef.

FOUR THOUSAND FOUR HUNDRED FORTY-FOUR---

The street is sick,
filled entirely with the delirium of working hands,
and sometimes it burns in the fever of unemployment.
Crows, black stains of exploitation on the sky,
strangle angels in the clouds.
The street is sick.
Working children—these wounds of the street—
multiply every day.
At the crossroads, a child is divided
into four thousand four hundred forty-four pieces.
At the intersections, the traffic lights
target children's joys
with red gunfire.
The street is sick,
and my work is to speak delirium.
And my deliriums
cannot be considered art
in any exhibition.

THE MANNEQUINS ARE ON STRIKE

The mannequins have gone on strike.
They have subtracted laughter
from the dry territory of their lips,
and now they chew
something like the rotten apple of seasons.
The mannequins of my homeland,
swollen within the shattered display windows of dreams,
float amid the tides of the brainless crowds—
their faces smell of dead fish,
and all the street's muscles
suffer a violent spasm.
The mannequins of my land smell of oil,
and the price of their flesh
is better known by empty barrels.
Inside their plastic intestines
lies the leftover sandwich
that has licked the pavement clean.
The mannequins
have rebelled—
at every crossroads they honk and scream,
while the street's muscles
remain locked
in an endless spasm.



About the author

Elham Hamedi, born in Shiraz, Iran in 1967, is a famous poetess, multimedia artist, painter, and writer. She holds a Master's degree in Artistic Research and a Degree in Radiology. She began writing poetry in 1990 and has participated in hundreds of international anthologies, literary magazines, and exhibitions. Hamedi is the author of the poetry book "Un colpo alla testa era uno Zaqboor" (Terra d'Ulivi, Italy, 2022), which has received international recognition, including awards from Città di Varallo and Isola d'Elba – Ascoltando i Silenzi del Mare. She has won numerous literary awards, including International Literary Award "Women for Culture and Peace" (Italy, 2022), Emozioni Poetiche (Milan, 2023), Premio Nosside (2024), Premio Internazionale di Poesia Città di Varallo (2023–2024), Il Canto di Dafne, Le Nove Muse, Cygnus Aureus, Premio Letterario "Ciò che Caino non sa" (2025), and Premio Albero Andronico (2025). She has been named one of the "50 Unforgettable Women of Asia" and a "Pillar of Asia's Culture" in the Stockholm 2033 project.



About the author

Sanaz Davoodzadehfar, an Iranian poetess born in Iran and living in Luxembourg now. She began her artistic career with the theater and played and worked in many plays and won many awards in this field. She began writing poetry in classical forms and Her poems were published in the most important Iranian journals and newspapers and sites like: Roudaki, zane emeooz, piadehro, neveshta ... Many of her poems were translated into other languages such as English, French, Spanish, German, Swedish, Kurdish. Her first collection "I walk on dead letters" was translated into Arabic and published in Tamoz publishing in Syria. Most of her poems were published in the most important Arabic newspapers and websites, such as Al-Ahram, Al-Dustour, Al-Adab, Al-Hayat and...

WOMEN, LIFE, FREEDOM

On my black hair
Pomegranate flowers have grown
This autumn smells like spring

This time freedom
from my hair
will rise
oh wind
twist my hair

Bullet
This time
All the boundaries of my body belong to you
Shoot
Shoot
My hair waves in the wind
It will drown you
bullet
bullets
We are afraid
in our wounds
We have buried
the freedom
I kiss your lips

In my eyes
deer
for peace
He will run through a passage full of mines
Maybe this explosion
The end of all wars

About the author

Adnan Al-Sayegh, an important poet, was born in Al-Kufa, a city on the banks of the Euphrates in Iraq in 1955. Adnan has published thirteen collections of poetry, including the 550-page *Uruk's Anthem* (Beirut 1996), the 1380-page *The Dice Of The Text* (Beirut & Baghdad 2022) and very short poems *Glimmerings... Of You* (London, Baghdad 2024). He left his homeland in 1993, lived in Amman, and Beirut then in 1996 took refuge in Sweden. Since 2004 he has been living in exile in London. His poems have been researched by PhD and Masters students in multiple Iraqi, Arabic and international universities. He has received several international awards; among them, the Hellman-Hammet International Poetry Award (New York 1996), the Rotterdam International Poetry Award (1997) and the Swedish Writers Association Award (2005), and has been invited to read his poems in many festivals across the world. His poetry had been translated into many languages. He is currently living in London.



DOORS

I rap on a door
It opens up
All I see of the door is me!
It opens up
Through I go
Nothing but another door.
Lord how many more
Holding myself back from
me?

TEXT

I forgot myself at my library desk
And got up to go
But as I started up the road
I realised that I was nothing but the shadow of a text
That I could see walking uneasily in front of me
And greeting people as if it were me



About the author

Peshawa Abdalla Abdalrahman, also known as Peshawa Kakayi, is a Kurdish poet and writer, was born in 1984 in Qaladze, Kurdistan Region of Iraq. He completed his primary, secondary and high school education in the same city. In 2008-2009, he obtained a Bachelor's degree in political sciences from Sulaimaniyah University. He has published articles in many newspapers and publications. He has published 21 collections of poems, written and published a research book, and a book on poetry based on four in-depth interviews. He has also translated four books into Persian. He has also translated a collection of poems into Arabic. Several of his poems have also been translated into other languages including Albanian, Uzbek, Spanish, Igbo, English, Indonesian, Bengali, Bosnian, Polish, Chinese, Russian, Serbian, Arabic, Persian, Kazakh, Kyrgyz/Kyrgyz, Macedonian. He has also received seventeen awards in 2020-2021-2022.

DUST HOUSE (excerpts)

I write
 What the Earth and sky tell me
 To write with the notebook of the wind
 With the pen of the cloud.
 Dust storm or not
 Is it coming?
 Are you blind?
 The air tells us:
 You, the dust, when you rain
 The sky's sight gets blurry.

For ages, they have wanted us to leave the Earth
 Who will move to Mars?
 Isn't it copy pasted here?

In the air
 The air is not itself and the Earth's skull is cracked,
 When it awakes,
 It forgets about rain, snow and hail.
 Colored or not,
 White becomes an old poem inside the snow to get obsolete!
 Flood becomes a prose for the calendar
 The farmers will read it in their farms.
 Hail breaks lesser windscreens than before
 Dust comes by itself, attaches itself to the windscreens,
 Only when the price of wipers goes higher
 Human beings understand their naivety
 Only then slam their heads against the wall.

Dust winds through the gardens
 Blinds the gardeners
 When it sees flowers' miscarriages!
 Wheat flowers cough,
 Saying, dream interpretation is unnecessary
 "If the situation continues as such
 Famine come to you every year."
 Grass forgets itself,
 Visits the hospitals
 To receive a share
 And the money lands in the pocket of a wealthy doctor!

Every month, we publish a schedule,
 Salary schedule
 Raining schedule
 Death schedule
 Battle casualties schedule
 Launching spaceships schedule,
 The dust too
 Announces its schedule so that
 Its name is in the sky every month.
 (Translated by Goran sabah)

Sun

When my mother passed through the streets
Cloaked in light
Trees and their branches turned towards her
Her eyes inspired warmth in all the world around her
And the grass under her feet sang

In the early morning hours
I saw her at the window, hanging out her laundry
I was still wrapped in dreams
And I would listen to her trembling voice

“The sun, my son
Is always on our side”

Since then
The sun is with me
In all seasons.

WOMAN – A WALKING STORM

When your storm is approaching
And little by little grows stronger
And bigger
It throws the tiles off my roof
It orders the trees to cast off their leaves

A storm of words is rising
A storm of thunder and lightning
Which darkens the horizons
Extinguishes and illumines
From time to time...

Woman
You are a walking, flesh and blood storm
Suddenly you forget the softness of your skin
Of your thighs
The beauty of your breasts
And your so ardently loving eyes

The storm bursts out of your flesh
And there's no escape from its ruling strength
And then
on the very threshold of the world's destruction

All at once dies down...



About the author

Balfour Hakak, a famous poet, was born in 1948. He was educated at Alliance school in Jerusalem. He won World Champion in the Bible quiz (1965). He holds Master's degrees with distinction at the Hebrew University in Jerusalem (1976). Writing textbooks and Curriculum-books for the Ministry of education (1978-2013). He has published books of poetry and stories for children. Chairman of Hebrew writers Association (2005-2011).



About the author

Iris Calif, an outstanding poetess, dancer, editor and translator, was born and lives in Israel. She is in charge of foreign relations in the online culture, literature, art and poetry magazine “The Direction of the Holy Spirit Wind” (“Bekiovn Hroh”) a translator and an editor of world-wide poetry in the magazine and editor of international anthologies at the magazine, as well as in the culture and lifestyle magazine “Mokasini” and in the “World Poetry” section on the literature website “Rooms” (“Hadarim”). She has won many international literary awards. Three of Iris's books have already been published: “In a Mysterious magical path Lolita breathes” (2001), “A Pure Wild moon” (2017), and “The daughter of God” (2020). Her poems have been published and read on the radio, on television, on the internet, in national and international magazines and newspapers and in anthologies around the world, and were translated by international poets into numerous languages such as Spanish, Bengali, Nepali, Arabic, Chinese, Turkish, Assamese, Russian, Albanian and Italian.

THE DESERT BRIDE

Lord of land and heaven

In the calm prayer of your rains, Simulates virtue of love
In God's garment to my body, I predict the sun ballerina of my body
To the silence of the divine wind

The darkness carrying love
Desire raising my dream
And the summer candle is lit by a holy life
Reigns in the crown of winter writings of my soul

The evening creates my passion that gives birth to existence
The night breathes the golden halo of my dance in the sand of the fields of the world
And in the knowledge of heaven
I am the bride of the desert

THE IRIS FLOWER OF YOUR HEART

My beloved

In the crown of the Iris heart flower of heaven,
I am dripping a golden- painted dawn into your eyes,
The prayer of the holy sun rain land, silenced her voice,

The hidden wind blows; the secrets of my wild moon dance

I remove the essence of the clothing of my Iris flower soul
in front of the halo river rock of your body.

I am the naked ballerina, The living Iris flower of heaven,
dancing your living Iris heart

My wet lips whispering to the purity of the human beauty darkness of
the Night of the loving;

Breath

Tonight

I am dripping,

The Iris flower of Your heart

URBAN MUSEUM

You will wander alone
In the crowded streets
In the ancient city
to the spies of
The Italians elves.

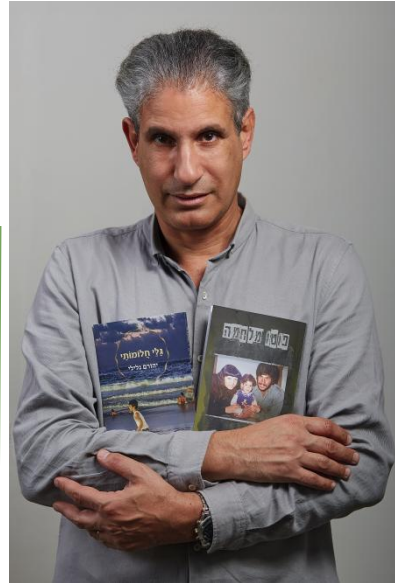
You won't stop whispering
by the hands of the Renaissance master
spoiling your body and soul,
turning you into a Human statue
in an urban museum.

It will not stick to the heels of your shoes
Old soot from paving stones,
that the Roman armies left behind
And Napoleon, as noblemen And kings
and electricity
with a passion for art.

When your measured steps stopped
At the corner of the street,
you will quench your thirst
with passers-by From the
water springing from
his mouth of a black bull,
The symbol of the city.

THE ELIXIR OF LIFE

If writing is the elixir of life,
Art is the syringe who
injects it into our body
in generous portions
Animating the soul.



About the author

Yehoram Galili, a famous writer, poet and literary and linguistic editor, the owner of Galili Publishing House, is a member of the Hebrew Writers Association, a graduate of a language editing course taught by Dr. Asia Sharon on behalf of the Asif Institute. These days Yehoram Galili is working on literary editing, linguistic editing and the production of additional books that will be published soon. He wrote books: "First First - The Legacy of the Combat Engineer Corps" and "One Chapter of Fulfillment in the Haganah and the IDF". Towards the end of 2021, Yehoram Galili won a financial grant of NIS 3,000 from the Akum creative encouragement fund for "Photo War" - the book of poems he wrote and published during 2022. In June 2017, a poem he wrote called "Photo War" won first place in a poetry contest organized by the online magazine "Bitaun Shira". Many poems written by Yoram were published in many literary journals and newspapers such as: "Haaretz", "Israel Hayom", "Maariv" and more.



About the author

Claudia Piccinno, a famous poetess, translator and teacher. She has been the Continental Director for Europe in the World Festival Poetry from April 2019 to September 2021, Gold medal to Frate Ilaro 2017, winner of Ossi di Seppia prize 2020, Pannunzio 2022, meritorious of the Municipality of Castel Maggiore for cultural merits. Her international awards include: Aco Karamanov in Macedonia, Ajtan Zhiti in Kosovo, Rosetta Stone, and the Feminenartfest in Istanbul. Head of the poetry column for the Istanbul Gazette, editor for Europe of the Turkish magazine Papyrus, published by Artshop; she collaborates with various blogs, emagazines and paper magazines, including Menabò, Verbumpress, Italine, CiaoMag, Poetry Land and Il Porticciolo. Her voice is present in the Poetry Sound Library curated by Giovanna Iorio.

EVIDENT OXYMORON

The dome shines
in the black hole.
The flame burns
in the dark night.
In the lock
the karma of life.
Eternity after death
love afterwards cries of pain
time swallows up thoughts
it digs furrows on helpless smiles.
The wrinkle is evident oxymoron
happiness lost
on the island that no longer exists.

MY FATHER'S TEXT MESSAGES

My father's text messages
still on the screen,
cord never cut
words for my mother
orphaned without him
Me too orphan without those two.
I inherited a brother and
two grandchildren,
an orange grove that buds memories
freesias that bloom for no reason
voiceless findings of a private affair.
My father's text messages
still on the screen
they talk about the ordeal
of the end,
the care of a man
the desperate search for meaning
a microstory of ordinary pain.

WORDS OF KISSES

I would kiss you more and more, but even
after
and then before
Without wasting time.
So that instants become kisses on you.
To feel my caramelized lips on yours
Everywhere I would kiss your skin,
in the most secret places,
tasting the sweetness of your smoothness
but now I would kiss you here, in the square
between chestnut trees and daisies,
to give a mellow voice
to the taste of our kisses,
to the spicy scent of our lips,
to our skin, intertwined from a thread of silk
to our smiles lost between plane trees and
cicadas.

THE IMMENSITY

Kiss me now, in this flash already passed by
as I see tumult in your eyes
as I feel your warm yearning body
like that scorching afternoon of July.
Because I want to feel you inside me.

Kiss me relentlessly
till we cannot tell my skin from your lips
till I feel my feet losing ground
and we go in the clean air scented with your breaths

and wandering along sunny beaches
running happily towards life.

Don't lose yourself in the escaping instant
don't let it go
the happiness of our being
which we have exchanged
in the thoughts, dreams, deepest and most passionate
senses.

Kiss me until it becomes the lively substance of existence.



About the author

Gabriella Picerno, a poetess, psychologist, educationalist, sexologist, was born in 1967 in Belvedere Marittimo (Cosenza). She is the director of the Educational Documentation Center "Il Grillo Parlante" in Rufina (Florence). For over twenty years, she has been involved in affective and sexual education in schools of all levels and created the Parlamore Project. She is the author of numerous psychological and educational essays, as well as novels and poetry. Her poems have been translated into seven languages and published in 15 countries, and several volumes of children's fairy tales have been translated into Turkish and Polish. She is the director of the Mille Abbracci series for Pav Edizioni and co-director, alongside Cristina Desideri, of the Il Filo di Arianna series for GD Edizioni. She writes articles on psychology and pedagogy for the magazine Docete, aimed at educators. Additionally, she curates the La Botteguccia delle Favole and Lo Zaino Raccontastorie literary awards.



About the author

Lidia Chiarelli, a famous poetess, writer, translator, artist, teacher, editor, was born in Turin, Italy. She began writing in 2009. Her major publications: "Immagine & Poesia-The Movement in Progress", A Cross-Cultural Communications Edition, -NY 2013; "Tramonto in una tazza-Sunset in a Cup", Edizioni Esordienti E book, Moncalieri (To-Italy) 2017; "Inclinazioni di luce - Slants of Light" A Cross-Cultural Communications Edition, NY 2019; "Il Richiamo dell'Onda" Vitale Edizioni, Sanremo 2020 (First Prize Edition for the finalists of Floriseum Poetry Contest, Sanremo, Italy). Her poetry and artworks published in more than 150 International Anthologies, Literary Journals, Catalogs, Websites, Blogs. Main Achievements: Six Pushcart Prize Nominations for Poetry (USA); Mario Merz Prize Nomination 2021 for Arts (ITALY); Literary Arts Medal 2020 (USA); Naji Naaman's Literary Prizes 2019; Three times First Prize winner in Poetry Contests (Porto Venere 2019, Savona 2020, Sanremo 2020); Twenty Poetry Awards in Italy and UK. Co-Editor of Immagine & Poesia yearly e book since 2014. She is coordinator of Dylan Day in Italy (Turin). Her poems have been translated into many languages.

GARDEN IN OCTOBER

In my Autumn garden I was fain
To mourn among my scattered roses
Christina Rossetti

Colours and sounds
mix in the October garden
where dying roses feed your soul.

Amber brown leaves waltz on the boughs
as you, Queen of Pre-Raphaelite beauty
discover wonder in
Autumn's languid sun
of this ephemeral reign.

And in the dappled light
your words become
a subtle song
a hymn of devotion
to the fugitive hour
to the vanishing moment.

LIGHT ON THE WALLS OF LIFE

to Lawrence Ferlinghetti

Teach me to paint
the light on the walls of life.

Teach me
to look at the world
as you see it
to become a tear of the sun
a hill of poetry
a word in a tree.

Lead me
to see the sun
hitting the sheer cliffs
the tides that restlessly ebb and flow
the water birds challenging the wind.

Let's listen together
to the breath of rustling leaves
the perfect hush of a starry night
the sound of summer in the raindrops.

Here and now
help me reach the very shores of light
waiting for
the renaissance of wonder

with you
again and forever

About the author

Maria Miraglia, a renowned Italian poetess, essayist, and translator. She is the Vice President of the World Movement for the Defense of Children, Kenya, and the founder of the World Foundation for Peace. Miraglia is a founding member and Literary Director of the Pablo Neruda Association and a member of several editorial boards of international literary magazines; Member of the International Writers Association; Member of the International Academy Mihai Eminescu. Miraglia got her most recent award, “50 Women Memorables Europea”, at the Pontifical University Antonianum, Rome. She writes in Italian, English, or both languages. Her poems have been translated into over thirty languages and are featured in more than one hundred anthologies worldwide. Dr Miraglia Maria Antonietta is Member of the European Academy of Science and Arts- Salzburg



SUNSET

If you feel tired of life
rejected by men
opposed by the fate
and can no longer
smell the scent of flowers
sense on you
the embrace of the winds
hear the voice of the silence
and faded is in you
for thousand reasons
the flame of love
stop your steps
and look at the sunset
its colours and magic
will give you back
the desire to live
lightheartedly your days
to the end
and draw on your face
new smiles
again and then again



About the author

Taki Yuriko, a famous poetess, was born in Tokyo, Japan in 1948. She Worked in NIPPON BROADCASTING SYSTEM, INC and in KUMON Institute of Education start 1961 (brank 1978-1997) restart 1998. She won 2006 “Neoung Keoum prize” from the Hangchon Culture Foundation in Korea; 2005 “Medal Festos” from International Society of Greek Writers & Arts. She has published and translated into 14 Languages from the following poetry book: 2022 “The Elegies of a Century”; 2013 and 2014 “Sakura, the Cherry Blossom”; 2006, 2010 and 2022 “Genocide”; 2002 and 2003 “8500 Christs”; 1976 “My Revolution Square” and in English, French, German, Spanish, Portuguese, Hangul, Chinese (and Taiwan), Russian, Romanian, Mongolian, Greek, Arabic, Albanian and Japanese.

A DEAD CHILD AT HIROSHIMA

The Sound of a bat flapping it's wings

Mama

Is the second of my knocking

A hole gapes in the sky

Mama

Is the scar of clouds scorched at the scattering of
my flesh.

The voice of Emperor Hirohito praying

Is my alarm clock screaming at me never to sleep.

Look, Mama

My little sisters are playing over my head.

From inside my eye

A single blade my grass

Is about to grow

Long have my eyes been bone dry

Mama

No longer do I cry

(Translated by Alan Richardson)

A THOUSAND AND ONE TIMES

I wasn't Sheherazade,
there was no king to listen to my stories,
no prince to grant me one more day of life,
I was telling stories to my self. I even
invented poems.

I travelled to my childhood,
wrote stories, some finished,
others as yet half imagined.
Recalling them in silence
kept me alive.

Oh, I am Sheherazade
and the king.

I have to listen to the landscapes
of myself, to stay alive
time and time again,
a thousand and one times.

LOOKING FOR ME

My homeland was far away,
my father dead,
my mother left behind,
my loved ones had gone away.

I stopped receiving letters.
My inbox was empty.
My phone fell silent.

My body was suddenly ageing.
My mind, emptied of memories,
slammed the door of thought.
The Mistral alone whispered at my window.

From faraway an alphabet came
shattering the silence into a necklace
of words. A winged word

was looking for me, I caught sight of it
flying just above my head.



About the author

Fathieh Saudi, a famous poetess and author, was born in Jordan in 1949. Having completed her medical studies in France, she worked as a consultant paediatrician in Jordan and Lebanon; Though connected to poetry through her life she only started writing poetry in her fifties and in English, her poetic language. Her published poetry collections, written in English, include: "Prophetic Children: Abraham Moses Jesus Mohammed", "Daughter of the Thames" (a semi autobiographical collection), and "Bint Alnahr" in Arabic. She has translated several books from English and French into Arabic, including books on health, psychology and novels. Fathieh is the recipient of several international awards for her social, cultural and humanitarian work, notably the Chevalier de L'Ordre National du Merite, from French government. At present she is Board member of English PEN and Exiled Writers Ink. She lives in London/UK.



About the author

Ainur Serikovna Kumarkhanova, a Kazakh poetess and translator, was born in 1983 in Semiyar village, Beskaragai district, Semipalatinsk region (now Abai Region), Kazakhstan. Between 2005 and 2011, she published several poetry collections, including “Noble Dream”, “My Swallows”, and “Pyramid”. Her poetry has been translated into English, Spanish, Turkish, Bulgarian, and other languages. She is the recipient of numerous international awards, including “Golden Feather” (Azerbaijan, Russia), “Poet of the World” (Spain), and “Poet of the Year” (Saudi Arabia). She participated in the “Great People of the Planet” project (India). Her works have been published in over 15 countries, actively promoting Kazakh poetry and cultural dialogue worldwide.

WAR

Let this cruel war be erased from the world,
Let a new day come, with dreams unfurled.
Let all weapons fall from every hand,
Let the harsh, grim face of war be banned.
Let children be freed from fear and dread,
Let laughter ring from every homestead.
Let executioners face their end,
For the lives they chose to rend.
Let hunger and pain be gone for good,
Let granaries overflow with food.
Let no mother know sorrow's night,
Let them greet peace and morning light.
Let war, oh war, be no more seen
Over Gaza's skies so serene.
And may only happiness reign in peace!
Let bloodshed end, forever cease —

About the author

Dina Oraz, true name Dinara Orazbekova, born in 1980 in the city of Kokshetau, Kazakhstan, lives in the city of Astana, is a famous poetess, writer, translator, presenter, journalist, head of the creative association “AVANGARD”, vice-president of the ICPD, vice-president of the International Chamber of Writers and Artists CIEZART (Spain) - Kazakhstan. Author of children's books “Who treats lions' teeth?”, “Where does the unicorn live?”, “What is my name?”. The author's works have been translated into Tajik, Azerbaijani, English, Belarusian, Ukrainian, Latvian, Turkish, Kazakh, Arabic, Kyrgyz, Italian, Uzbek, Bengali, Slovenian, Macedonian languages.



SOUNDS

Whispers and tender languor;
a moment of oblivion,
a second of pleasure –
the mystery of existence.

The heat of the night, night-
time caresses, passion until morning,
a blissful dream,
a fairy tale, a new spark.

In the milky stars, shadows
and sounds lure with caresses;
the merging of bodies
and the torment of a sigh... fire, fire...



About the author

Alex Nderitu, pen name: Alexander Nderitu, was born in 1979 in Nyeri, Kenya, is a poet, novelist, playwright, literary critic. He began to writing and publishing works in 2001. His poems have appeared in The East African Standard (Kenya), Ars Artium (India), My Africa, My City: An Afridiapora Anthology (Nigeria), World Poetry Almanac (Mongolia) and his own poetry books. During the 2014 Commonwealth Games in

Glasgow, Scotland, his narrative poem Someone in Africa Loves You represented Kenyan literature on Commonwealth Postcards. He won Business Daily Kenya's 'Top 40 Under 40 Kenyan Men' (2017), Share Africa Climate Fiction Award (2022), SEVHAGE-Agema Founders' Prize for African Criticism (2023) and a Sahitto International Prizes for Literature Jury Award (2023). Major publications of poems: The Moon is Made of Green Cheese, King Bure is Dead! Where the Kremlin Live. He currently resides in Nairobi, Kenya.

TILL THE COWS COME HOME

There's no way I'm going to join the rat race,
Chasing lights like a moth to a flame.
You say the city holds so much promise.
I could have a career, make loads of cash,
Buy an apartment and some shiny cars.
And after retirement, I could just sit back
On my balcony and watch the setting sun.
And I'm thinking, 'Really? That's success?'

I sit on my verandah, every single day,
Looking out over the family farm, the livestock,
The tractor, the water tower, the crops.
I love the smell of the earth and manure.
My dog, Mufasa, lies at my feet as I sip sweet ukwaju.
Sometimes, my neighbours or some cousins join me
And we play classic country songs
And have ourselves a jamboree!
So, you can talk about urbanity till the cows come home
But I ain't trading this life for city lights.

About the author

Bob Mwangi Kihara, a Kenyan poet, writer. He has more than three-and-a-half decades of experience in journalism, media relations and poetry at national and international level. He was born in 1965 at Mount Kenya Hospital, Nyeri Town in Kenya. Currently an UN-retiree. In September 1995, Bob won the Global Media Award for Population and Health Reporting from the Population Institute of the United States. His poetry has been shared widely in the US, Europe, Asia and Africa. Through the Spain-based ITHACA Project, some of his poetry has been translated into 30 languages. For some years now, he has been translating poetry for ITHACA from English into the Kiswahili language spoken in East and Central Africa. Among magazines that have published his poems are 'Seventh Quarry', UK, 'Thorny Locust', US, 'Oberon Magazine', US, 'Mediterranean Odyssey', 'Korean Expatriate Literature' (KEL) and 'Our Poetry Archive,' India. In 2025 Bob published a trilingual chapbook titled 'The Lion Roars in the Savannah' in English, Gikuyu and Kiswahili languages.



THE POET SPEAKS IN SILENCE

The poet speaks in silence Amazulu.
Where there is peace and where there is honour.
Where there is faith and where there is dignity.
The poet speaks where there is love,
Where there is trust and respect,
Not where hatred flourishes in deceit.
The poet roars in his silence,
Where there is introspection in truthfulness,
Where friendship is genuine, not feigned.

The poet speaks in the happiness of silence,
Where anger is contained and managed,
Where there is room for a bright soul.
The poet speaks where there is goodness,
Of mind, body, soul, spirit and relationships.
Where good thoughts are bred and encouraged.
The poet is a child of loud silence.
As silent as the stars, the poet flickers brightly,
For ages and eons, if the poem is wise.

But beware, the poet's silence is very loud, especially so when the converse of virtue arrives on the scene.



About the author

Kang Byeong-Cheol, a distinguished Korean author, poet, translator, and Doctor of Philosophy in Political Science, was born in Jeju City, South Korea, in 1964. He began his literary journey in 1993 and published his first short story, *Song of Shuba*, at the age of twenty-nine. In 2005, he released his first collection of short stories, marking an important milestone in his career. Over the years, he has published more than eight books and has been honored with five literature awards for his contributions to Korean and world literature. Dr. Kang's engagement with international literary communities has been extensive. From 2009 to 2014, he served as a member of the Writers in Prison Committee (WiPC) of PEN International, actively supporting the freedom of expression for writers worldwide. He also served as the Founding President of the Korean Association of World Literature, contributing to global literary dialogue and exchange. In addition, he has worked as an editorial writer for *JeminIlbo*, a leading newspaper in Jeju City, where he offered insights on cultural and political issues. Currently, Dr. Kang serves as Vice President of the Korean Institute for Peace and Cooperation and Vice President of Jeju PEN.

WHEN LOVE MEETS US

Everyone longs for love,
searching far for its radiant flame.
But love is not a roadside gem,
nor found in sunsets or science's name.

It hides not in beauty's shallow face,
but calls from deeper, higher grace.
A rose blooms when love is near,
fed by care, sunlight, and cheer.

Love is compassion, gentle and true,
without which no life can renew.
Beyond the fence, a rose may say:
"I see love, I hear love, I love it each day."

Its price is not wealth, nor power's disguise,
but pride surrendered, and hearts made wise.
Love does not come from law or decree,
It blooms within, where the soul is free.

SUNSET SCENE

When the blazing sun hides its body beneath the earth,
it is serene and majestic.
The crimson-stained evening
slowly burns the edge of the sky.

On a clear day, that grand and beautiful sight
though its warmth has almost faded,
the great red circle
becomes a half-moon, then a faint trace,
and at last, as if it were nothing at all,
sinks into the horizon.

In that moment,
the quiet evening grows even stiller.
Yesterday's news, a poet had departed this world,
a life had spent its final light,
a silent condolence sent from deep within the heart.

Not every day grants such a glorious sunset.
Just as the sky must be clear,
for a person to depart beautifully,
the fire within must first
burn clear and bright.

LIKE A SINGLE WORD

The sky and the earth are the lips of eternity.
There,
we live like a single word.

Like a ring worn without knowing
whose hand placed it,
people live, fitted into the world.

Today,
I do not know where I am.
Just standing—
Hands engraving handprints,
feet engraving footprints.

Life is finding a path in the void.
Birds know
that the void is eternity.
Living is the breaking of one boundary after another.

Life grows colder as it goes on.
The time they wrote
abandons them in the end.

On a spring day when cherry blossoms befriend the wind,
mountain-like buildings,
valley-like alleys,
water-like people.

People, worn by strangeness,
save it sparingly, fearing they might grow used to it.
An angel slips between their lips,
and they take out a single smile.

THE TITMOUSE

In the mountain where silence bustles,
humming bees, wild birds, mayflies,
is it a path half-floating in the air, or a mingled ringing of bells?

Ancient hieroglyph, a handful of rocks,
as they creak open a door and yawn,
a squirrel slips into a mouse hole—its home, perhaps—
then scurries, skittering away.

Into the whole mountain's solitude, through the fissures of my
monologue,
a titmouse in flight stops to speak,
then is gone.



About the author

Siyoung Doung, a distinguished Korean poetess and scholar, graduated from Dongguk University with a degree in Korean Language and Literature and earned her Ph.D. in the same field from Hanyang University. She further broadened her academic horizons through advanced studies in the humanities at Regensburg University in Germany. Her teaching career has included professorships at Korea Tourism University and Jilin University of Finance and Economics in China. She made her literary debut in 2003 in the magazine Dacheung and has since published numerous acclaimed poetry collections, such as *Future Hunting*, *In Search of a Strange God*, *The Phone Call from God*, *The Eyes of November*, *The Scent of Secrets*, *Aria of Everyday Life*, and *The Horizon Never Gets Wet*. Alongside poetry, she has produced influential critical works, including Roh Cheon-myung's *Poetry and Semiotics* and *Semiotics of Modern Poetry*, as well as essay collections exploring culture and travel. Her literary achievements have been honored with many awards, including the Park Hwa-mok Literary Award, the Dongguk Literary Award, and the Yeongrang Literary Award for Criticism. Currently serving as President of the Korean Association of World Literature, she resides in Seoul.



About the author

Altynai Temirova, a poetess, playwright and translator. In 1990, she graduated from the Institute of Literature named after M. Gorky in Moscow. She is a member of the Writers' Union of the Kyrgyz Republic since 1991. She is a coordinator representing Kyrgyzstan for "World Poets Movement" (WPM). Altynai Temirova's poetry was translated into German, Russian, Bashkir, Finnish, Hindi, Chinese, Kazakh, Uzbek, Sakha-Yakut, English, Norwegian languages. It was published in foreign press, books, almanacs and anthological collections. She has won several international literary awards. She translates the works of the best modern poets of the "world movement of poets" (WPM), publishes anthologies, and also raises Kyrgyz poetry to the world level.

LIFE -

Like a deaf, blind and cruel
inquisitor of the times
and ages...
Life tortures people with all sorts of trials,
exposing to different tests
playing like a toy for its "jokes"...
All senses and colors of
whole our inner world
we're wasting, for life
just to be able to say -
that we are here
to struggle for life...
On red and white string
of the Fate,
we threaded like rosary beads,
to the enigma,
and mystery
allure,
like tenderness of beauty
remaining enchanted...

WOMAN . . . WRITING THE LIGHT

She is the woman who rises from the ashes of seasons,
carrying in one hand a river,
and in the other, the ember of creation.
She is born from the womb of time,
to rearrange the seasons upon the face of the earth.

When the wind walks, it follows her steps,
and when the sea is silent, its waves speak her name.
She plants words in the desert of speech,
and the poems turn green like the wings of seagulls.

No mirror can complete her,
for her features stretch beyond the glass.
In her eyes dwells the sadness of galaxies,
and in her heart, a sun that heals darkness.

She mends the fracture of pain with a thread of tenderness,
and weaves from her fatigue a garment of joy.
She asks the rain about her secret,
and it comes weeping at the beauty of the question.

The woman is a melody of the first clay,
molded by the Creator from patience and dew.
When she grieves, gardens wither,
and when she smiles, meanings bloom.

She fights in silence,
and forgives with an unseen light.
She does not seek glory,
for it has lived in her shadow since eternity.

Each morning she writes herself anew,
hanging her dream upon the wing of a cloud.
She hides the world within her embrace,
and returns to the earth the meaning of "mother."
She is the woman... God's open book of mercy.

SHADOWS OF TIME

Time walks barefoot upon my face,
drawing its wrinkles with ink and wonder.
It drags behind it the moan of yesterday,
and hides tomorrow in the pocket of the wind.

It is not an hour measured by minutes,
but a breath echoing between death and rebirth.
Each moment sleeps in the womb of another,
and every birth is the shadow of a new demise.

Time does not grow old,
we are the ones who wither within it like tales.
It never departs
it is we who fade from its mirror.



About the author

Taghrid Bou Merhi, a distinguished Lebanese-Brazilian poet, writer, translator, and journalist, recognized as one of the prominent literary voices in the contemporary Arab world. Born in Lebanon and residing in Brazil, she serves as a cultural bridge between East and West through her prolific literary output and multilingual translations. Taghrid has published over 23 books and supervised the translation of 45 literary works into Arabic and other languages. Her writings have been translated into 49 languages and featured in more than 270 Arab and international anthologies, as well as in prestigious magazines and newspapers worldwide. She holds several cultural and international positions, including President of the Lebanon branch of CIESART, and membership in editorial boards of multiple Arab and foreign magazines. Taghrid has received numerous international awards recognizing her contributions to literature and translation.

About the author



Muhammad Gaddafi Masoud, a poet, was born in 1978 in Gharyan, Libya. He began writing poetry in 1996 in his hometown of Gharyan. He obtained an intermediate diploma, specializing in theater arts, from the Jamal al-Din al-Miladi Institute in the Libyan capital, Tripoli, in 2000. He writes poetry in Arabic, and his poems have been published in various Arab newspapers and magazines. His collection of poetry was published in 2007 in Libya for a single edition. Some of his poems have also been translated into English, Spanish, Italian, Albanian, and Chinese, and published in newspapers, magazines, and websites in Italy, Argentina, Greece, China, Spain, Serbia, Romania, Bengal, and America.

RAINY TURQUOISE

Between me and autumn
Desires live.
Turquoise seems as rain
And pain that winter can't bear.
Every cloud, even if it is about to fade,
Will not rain like the streams of my pain.
Oh, my anxiety, when it blossoms insomnia
And helplessness throughout the storm
The question sways between a heart and a poem.
(Translated by Zaid Al-Shaheed)